

Personal Beliefs Baseline

Ebenezer Isaac — Plymouth Brethren-adjacent — classical Reformed Protestant orthodoxy + Brethren distinctives

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Doctrinal precision and visible fruit are independent axes. tier=essential errors break fellowship absolutely. tier=convictional errors break membership but allow visit/participate. tier=preference differences MUST NOT outweigh demonstrable Christian fruit (love, joy, welcome) when discerning a local church. The point of this file is calibrated discernment, not scoring churches.

Tier	Definition	Count
ESSENTIAL	Core gospel and Trinitarian boundaries. Denial = false gospel or cult-grade error. Always teach to children, always correct, never become member where denied.	71
CONVICTIONAL	Clear scriptural conviction. Membership-level threshold. Would not compromise on doctrine, but visit/participate is usually fine where denied.	85
IMPORTANT	Matters significantly but does not break fellowship. Reservations about membership, but not absolute. Marry across is usually fine.	50
PREFERENCE	Methodological or practical. Membership across is fine. Worship style, communion frequency, calendar customs.	34
ADIAPHORA	Truly indifferent. Freedom of conscience. All thresholds permissive.	1

Index columns — full legend: Tier = importance (color-coded; see footer of every page). **M** = martyrdom 0-10 (0 = indifferent, 10 = would die for it). **Pos** = personal stance — **A**ffirm, **D**eny, **O**pen, **?** Uncertain. **V / P / S / Mb** = relationship ladder if a church teaches the opposite: **V**isit, **P**articipate, **S**erve in ministry, become a **M**ember. **Y** = applies (allowed), - = does not. **Cult** = denial of this doctrine flags cult-grade error. **Brt** = position is a Brethren-tradition distinctive.

The header on every page lists the position glyphs and Y/- markers. The footer lists the column abbreviations and the tier color key. The two are complementary — together they cover every symbol on the page.

Index — All Entries

Bibliology (10)

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	BrT
doc-ongoing-revelation-binding	No revelation given after the apostolic age binds the conscience or stands on par with Scripture.	ESSENTIAL	10	A	-	-	-	-	Y	Y
doc-scripture-final-authority	Scripture is the final and supreme authority for the Church, above all tradition, councils, and personal experience.	ESSENTIAL	10	A	Y	-	-	-		Y
doc-scripture-inerrancy	Scripture in the original autographs is without error in all that it affirms, including history, science, and theology.	ESSENTIAL	9	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-scripture-infallibility	Scripture cannot fail to accomplish what God intends and is incapable of misleading in matters of faith and practice.	ESSENTIAL	9	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-scripture-inspiration-verbal-plenary	All Scripture is verbally and plenary inspired by God, such that the very words of the original autographs are God-breathed.	ESSENTIAL	10	A	Y	-	-	-	Y	
doc-scripture-sufficiency	Scripture is sufficient for faith, doctrine, and practice — no further revelation is needed for salvation or godliness.	ESSENTIAL	9	A	Y	-	-	-		Y
doc-canon-66-books	The biblical canon comprises the 39 Old Testament and 27 New Testament books recognized by the Protestant tradition.	CONVICTIONAL	6	A	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-scripture-errantism-denial	Errantism — the view that Scripture contains real errors in matters of history, science, or doctrine — is to be rejected.	CONVICTIONAL	7	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-scripture-perspicuity	Scripture is sufficiently clear in matters necessary for salvation that any literate believer with the Spirit's help can grasp them.	CONVICTIONAL	7	A	Y	Y	-	-		Y
doc-apocrypha-non-canonical	The Apocryphal/Deuterocanonical books are not Scripture and are not authoritative for doctrine, though they may have historical value.	IMPORTANT	5	A	Y	Y	-	-		

Theology Proper (15)

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
doc-divine-holiness	God is utterly holy — set apart in moral purity and majestic transcendence.	ESSENTIAL	9	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-divine-love	God is love in His very essence, eternally loving within the Trinity and toward His creatures.	ESSENTIAL	9	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-divine-omnipotence	God is all-powerful, able to do all that He wills, limited only by His own nature.	ESSENTIAL	9	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-divine-omniscience	God knows all things, actual and possible, past, present, and future, exhaustively and eternally.	ESSENTIAL	9	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-divine-sovereignty	God sovereignly rules over all things, working all events according to the counsel of His will.	ESSENTIAL	9	A	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-god-existence	The one true and living God exists eternally as the self-existent creator and sustainer of all things.	ESSENTIAL	10	A	-	-	-	-	Y	
doc-modalism-denial	Modalism — the view that Father, Son, and Spirit are merely modes or roles of one person — is to be rejected as heretical.	ESSENTIAL	9	A	-	-	-	-	Y	

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
doc-trinity	God exists eternally as one being in three co-equal, co-eternal, distinct persons: Father, Son, and Holy Spirit.	ESSENTIAL	10	A	-	-	-	-	Y	
doc-tritheism-denial	Tritheism — the view that the three persons are three separate gods — is to be rejected as heretical.	ESSENTIAL	9	A	-	-	-	-	Y	
doc-divine-aseity	God is self-existent, deriving His being from nothing outside Himself.	CONVICTIONAL	7	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-divine-immutability	God is unchanging in His being, perfections, purposes, and promises.	CONVICTIONAL	7	A	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-divine-omnipresence	God is fully present everywhere, not bounded by space, while remaining distinct from creation.	CONVICTIONAL	7	A	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-open-theism-denial	Open Theism — the view that God does not exhaustively know future free human actions — is to be rejected.	CONVICTIONAL	7	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-divine-decrees	God eternally decrees whatsoever comes to pass, in a way consistent with creaturely responsibility.	IMPORTANT	4	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		
doc-divine-simplicity	God is not composed of parts; His attributes are identical with His essence.	IMPORTANT	4	A	Y	Y	-	Y		

Christology (13)

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
doc-bodily-ascension	Christ ascended bodily into heaven forty days after His resurrection.	ESSENTIAL	9	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-bodily-resurrection-of-christ	Jesus Christ rose bodily from the dead on the third day.	ESSENTIAL	10	A	-	-	-	-	Y	
doc-christ-full-deity	Jesus Christ is fully and truly God, of one substance (homoousios) with the Father.	ESSENTIAL	10	A	-	-	-	-	Y	
doc-christ-full-humanity	Jesus Christ is fully and truly human, taking on a complete human nature including body and rational soul.	ESSENTIAL	10	A	-	-	-	-	Y	
doc-christ-sinlessness	Jesus Christ was without sin in His thoughts, words, and deeds throughout His earthly life.	ESSENTIAL	10	A	-	-	-	-		
doc-christ-sole-mediator	Christ is the sole mediator between God and humanity; no saint, angel, or Mary mediates access to God.	ESSENTIAL	9	A	Y	-	-	-		Y
doc-eternal-sonship	The Son is eternally the Son — co-eternal and co-equal with the Father — not adopted or begun in time.	ESSENTIAL	9	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-hypostatic-union	Christ is one person in two natures — fully divine and fully human — without confusion, change, division, or separation.	ESSENTIAL	9	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-vicarious-atonement	Christ died as a substitute, bearing the penalty for the sins of His people in their place.	ESSENTIAL	10	A	-	-	-	-	Y	
doc-virgin-birth	Jesus Christ was conceived by the Holy Spirit and born of the virgin Mary.	ESSENTIAL	9	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-christ-session-exaltation	The risen Christ is exalted at the right hand of the Father, reigning and interceding for His people.	CONVICTIONAL	8	A	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-kenoticism-denial	Kenoticism — the view that Christ surrendered or gave up divine attributes in the incarnation — is to be rejected.	CONVICTIONAL	6	A	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-christ-two-wills	Christ possesses two wills — divine and human — corresponding to His two natures, working in harmony.	IMPORTANT	4	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		

Pneumatology (9)

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
doc-spirit-full-deity	The Holy Spirit is fully and truly God, co-equal and co-eternal with the Father and the Son.	ESSENTIAL	10	A	-	-	-	-	Y	
doc-spirit-indwelling	The Holy Spirit indwells every true believer permanently from the moment of regeneration.	ESSENTIAL	9	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-spirit-personhood	The Holy Spirit is a personal being — possessing intellect, will, and emotion — not an impersonal force or energy.	ESSENTIAL	10	A	-	-	-	-	Y	
doc-spirit-regeneration	The Holy Spirit is the agent of regeneration, granting new birth to those dead in sin.	ESSENTIAL	9	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-blasphemy-of-spirit	Blasphemy against the Holy Spirit — final, hardened rejection of His witness to Christ — is unforgivable.	CONVICTIONAL	6	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		
doc-spirit-baptism-at-conversion	Spirit baptism (being baptized into the body of Christ by the Spirit) occurs at conversion for every believer, not as a subsequent second blessing.	CONVICTIONAL	6	A	Y	Y	-	-		Y
doc-spirit-illumination	The Holy Spirit illumines Scripture to believers, enabling spiritual understanding of God's word.	CONVICTIONAL	7	A	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-spirit-sealing	The Holy Spirit seals every believer as God's possession, guaranteeing their final inheritance.	CONVICTIONAL	7	A	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-spirit-procession	The Holy Spirit eternally proceeds from the Father (and from the Son, per the Western tradition).	IMPORTANT	3	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		

Anthropology (4)

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
doc-adam-historical	Adam and Eve were real historical persons, the first human pair, from whom all humanity descends; they were specially created and not the product of unguided e...	CONVICTIONAL	7	A	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-gender-binary	God created humanity male and female as a fixed binary rooted in creation; biological sex and gender identity are coherent and not subject to self-determined r...	CONVICTIONAL	7	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-image-of-god	All human beings are created in the image of God (imago Dei), bearing inherent dignity, moral agency, rationality, and capacity for relationship with God, irre...	CONVICTIONAL	7	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-body-soul-constitution	Human beings are a unity of material body and immaterial soul/spirit; whether constitution is dichotomous (body+soul) or trichotomous (body+soul+spirit) is a d...	PREFERENCE	1	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		Y

Hamartiology (8)

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
doc-fall-historical	The Fall was a real historical event in which Adam, as covenant head, disobeyed God, plunging humanity and the created order into sin, death, and corruption.	CONVICTIONAL	8	A	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-inability-of-fallen-man	Fallen humans, apart from the Spirit's prior work, are unable to please God, repent, or believe savingly; the natural man cannot receive the things of the Spir...	CONVICTIONAL	6	A	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-original-sin	All human beings are born with a sinful nature inherited from Adam, sharing in his guilt and corruption, and are by nature objects of divine wrath.	CONVICTIONAL	8	A	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-sin-as-transgression	Sin is any want of conformity to, or transgression of, the law of God — in thought, word, deed, and disposition — and is fundamentally an offense against God's...	CONVICTIONAL	7	A	Y	Y	-	-		

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
doc-total-depravity	Sin has corrupted every faculty of fallen man — mind, will, affections, body — such that no part is untouched and unaided man cannot save himself or initiate s...	CONVICTIONAL	7	A	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-conscience-witness	Conscience is a divinely-given internal witness to God's law that, though damaged by sin, accuses or excuses moral agents and renders all without excuse before...	IMPORTANT	4	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		
doc-federal-headship-adam	Adam acted as the covenant/federal head of humanity, so that his sin and its consequences are imputed to all his natural descendants, paralleling Christ as fed...	IMPORTANT	5	A	Y	Y	-	Y		
doc-idolatry-root-sin	Idolatry — exchanging the glory of the Creator for created things — is the root of all sin; every transgression is a derivative form of misplaced worship.	IMPORTANT	4	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		

Soteriology (28)

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
doc-glorification	At Christ's return, believers will be raised bodily, transformed, and glorified — the final consummation of salvation in resurrection bodies free from sin and...	ESSENTIAL	9	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-imputed-righteousness	In justification, the active and passive righteousness of Christ is imputed (reckoned, credited) to the believer, so that the believer stands clothed in Christ...	ESSENTIAL	9	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-justification-forensic	Justification is a forensic, declarative act of God in which He pardons sinners and accounts them righteous in His sight — not on the basis of any inherent cha...	ESSENTIAL	9	A	Y	-	-	-	Y	
doc-pelagianism-denial	Pelagianism — the teaching that humans are born morally neutral, unaffected by Adam's sin, and able to choose God and obey His law by natural ability — is a de...	ESSENTIAL	9	D	Y	-	-	-		
doc-penal-substitution	The atonement is penal in nature: Christ bore the just punishment and divine wrath that sinners deserved, satisfying God's justice and propitiating His wrath.	ESSENTIAL	9	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-pluralism-inclusivism-denial	Religious pluralism (all paths lead to God) and Christian inclusivism (people may be saved through other religions because of Christ without explicit faith) ar...	ESSENTIAL	10	D	Y	-	-	-	Y	
doc-prosperity-gospel-denial	The prosperity gospel — that faith in Christ guarantees material wealth, physical health, and earthly success, often via 'sowing' financial seed — is a denied...	ESSENTIAL	9	D	Y	-	-	-	Y	
doc-repentance	Repentance — a Spirit-given change of mind toward sin and toward God, issuing in turning from sin to Christ — is integral to saving conversion, never separable...	ESSENTIAL	9	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-sola-fide	Justification is by faith alone (sola fide) — faith being the empty hand that receives Christ's imputed righteousness; works are the necessary fruit, never the...	ESSENTIAL	10	A	Y	-	-	-	Y	
doc-sola-gratia	Salvation is by grace alone (sola gratia) — wholly God's unmerited favour, never earned, contributed to, or co-purchased by human effort, ritual, or pedigree.	ESSENTIAL	10	A	Y	-	-	-	Y	
doc-solus-christus	Salvation is in Christ alone (solus Christus); there is no other name under heaven by which men must be saved, no other mediator between God and man.	ESSENTIAL	10	A	Y	-	-	-	Y	
doc-substitutionary-atonement	Christ died as a substitute in the place of sinners, bearing the penalty due for their sin so that they might be reconciled to God.	ESSENTIAL	9	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-works-righteousness-denial	Works-righteousness — any system in which human merit, sacraments, ritual, law-keeping, or moral effort partly or wholly grounds justification before God — is...	ESSENTIAL	10	D	Y	-	-	-	Y	
doc-adoption	By adoption, those justified are received into the family of God, granted the privileges, name, and inheritance of sons through union with Christ and indwellin...	CONVICTIONAL	6	A	Y	Y	-	-		

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
doc-antinomianism-denial	Antinomianism — that grace abolishes any binding role for God's moral law in the Christian life, so that obedience is optional or irrelevant — is a denied erro...	CONVICTIONAL	7	D	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-conversion	Conversion is the conscious human response to the gospel — repentance and faith — by which the regenerated sinner turns from sin to Christ; both gift of God an...	CONVICTIONAL	6	A	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-legalism-denial	Legalism — adding human rules to God's commands as conditions of acceptance, fellowship, or sanctification, or treating obedience as the ground rather than fru...	CONVICTIONAL	6	D	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-perseverance-eternal-security	Those truly born again will be kept by the power of God through faith unto final salvation; genuine believers cannot ultimately and finally fall away.	CONVICTIONAL	6	A	Y	Y	-	-		Y
doc-progressive-sanctification	Sanctification is the progressive, Spirit-wrought work of conforming believers to the image of Christ — distinct from justification but inseparable from it; en...	CONVICTIONAL	7	A	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-regeneration-monergistic	Regeneration (the new birth) is a monergistic work of the Holy Spirit, sovereignly imparting spiritual life to those dead in sin; logically prior to and the ca...	CONVICTIONAL	7	A	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-semi-pelagianism-denial	Semi-Pelagianism — the teaching that the sinner takes the first step toward God by natural ability, with grace then assisting — is a denied error.	CONVICTIONAL	7	D	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-assurance-of-salvation	Believers may have well-grounded assurance of salvation, founded on the promises of God in Christ, the inward witness of the Spirit, and the evidence of Spirit...	IMPORTANT	5	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		
doc-decisional-regeneration	Decisional regeneration — the view that salvation is effected by the act of decision (raised hand, walked aisle, repeated prayer) rather than by Spirit-wrought...	IMPORTANT	4	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		Y
doc-effectual-calling	God calls His people through the Word and Spirit — outwardly through preaching and inwardly so that the call is effective unto salvation in those who respond b...	IMPORTANT	4	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		
doc-election	Before the foundation of the world, God chose a people for salvation in Christ; whether election is unconditional (Calvinist) or based on foreseen faith (class...	IMPORTANT	4	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		Y
doc-extent-of-atonement	The atonement is sufficient for all but applied/efficient for the elect (or, in some traditions, genuinely universal in provision); Brethren tradition typicall...	IMPORTANT	4	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		Y
doc-means-of-grace	God ordinarily nourishes faith and sanctifies His people through appointed means: the Word read and preached, prayer, the breaking of bread, baptism, and Spiri...	IMPORTANT	4	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		
doc-sinners-prayer-method	The 'sinner's prayer' as a evangelistic tool is permissible if it expresses genuine repentance and faith, but is dangerous when treated as a saving formula or...	PREFERENCE	2	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		Y

Ecclesiology (8)

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
doc-christ-alone-head-of-church	Christ alone is the Head of the Church; no human being holds that office or shares that authority.	ESSENTIAL	10	A	-	-	-	-	Y	
doc-church-body-of-christ	The Church is the body of Christ, a spiritual organism composed of all true believers from Pentecost to the rapture, united to Christ by the indwelling Holy Sp...	ESSENTIAL	9	A	-	-	-	-		
doc-autonomy-of-local-assembly	Each local assembly is autonomous under Christ's headship, governed by its own elders, not subordinate to a denominational hierarchy or external bishop.	CONVICTIONAL	6	A	Y	Y	-	-		Y
doc-marks-of-true-church	A true visible church is marked by: (1) the Word of God rightly preached, (2) the ordinances rightly administered, (3) church discipline rightly exercised.	CONVICTIONAL	7	A	Y	-	-	-		

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
doc-no-clergy-laity-distinction	Scripture knows no two-tier clergy/laity distinction; all believers are saints and ministers, with elders functioning as servant-overseers, not a priestly clas...	CONVICTIONAL	6	A	Y	Y	-	-		Y
doc-one-holy-catholic-apostolic-church	The Church is one (united in Christ), holy (set apart, indwelt by the Spirit), catholic (universal across time and place), and apostolic (built on the apostles...	CONVICTIONAL	7	A	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-priesthood-of-all-believers	Every believer is a priest before God through Christ; there is no mediatorial priesthood between Christ and the believer beyond Christ Himself.	CONVICTIONAL	7	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-universal-vs-local-church	The Church exists in two senses: universal (all believers in all times and places) and local (particular gatherings of believers in covenanted fellowship).	IMPORTANT	4	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		

Sacraments (11)

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
doc-baptismal-regeneration-denial	Baptism does not regenerate, save, or wash away sin in itself (ex opere operato); it is the outward sign of an inward reality already accomplished by grace through faith.	CONVICTIONAL	7	D	-	-	-	-		
doc-memorial-view-lords-supper	The Lord's Supper is primarily a memorial of Christ's once-for-all atoning death, accompanied by spiritual communion with the risen Christ by faith. It is not a sacrifice.	CONVICTIONAL	6	A	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-paedobaptism-denial	Infant baptism (paedobaptism) lacks New Testament warrant; the covenant-of-grace argument from circumcision is theologically inadequate to override the consistent teaching of the Church that baptism is for believers only.	CONVICTIONAL	5	D	Y	Y	-	-		Y
doc-transubstantiation-denial	Transubstantiation — the Roman doctrine that the substance of the bread and wine is changed into the substance of Christ's body and blood while only the accidents remain — is not biblical.	CONVICTIONAL	7	D	-	-	-	-		
doc-two-ordinances	Christ instituted two ordinances for the Church: baptism and the Lord's Supper. They are signs and seals, not means of saving grace ex opere operato.	CONVICTIONAL	5	A	Y	Y	-	-		
prc-believers-baptism-by-immersion	Baptism is for professing believers only, administered by full immersion as a public confession of faith and identification with Christ's death, burial, and resurrection.	CONVICTIONAL	6	A	Y	Y	-	-		Y
doc-consubstantiation-position	Consubstantiation (the Lutheran 'in, with, and under' the elements) preserves real-presence language without transubstantiation but introduces ubiquity claims.	IMPORTANT	3	D	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-roman-seven-sacrament-system-denial	The Roman Catholic seven-sacrament system (baptism, confirmation, eucharist, penance, anointing of the sick, holy orders, matrimony) lacks NT warrant for treatment as sacraments.	IMPORTANT	4	D	-	-	-	-		
prc-foot-washing-not-ordinance	Foot-washing (John 13) is a beautiful pattern of servant love but was not instituted by Christ as an ongoing ordinance for the Church alongside baptism and the Lord's Supper.	PREFERENCE	1	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		
prc-open-vs-closed-communication	Communion should be open to all believers in Christ who are walking in fellowship with the Lord and not under church discipline, regardless of denominational affiliation.	PREFERENCE	2	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		
prc-weekly-breaking-of-bread	The Lord's Supper (breaking of bread) is observed weekly on the Lord's Day as the central act of corporate worship.	PREFERENCE	1	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		Y

Leadership & Polity (15)

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
doc-apostolic-succession-denial	Apostolic succession as an unbroken episcopal line conferring valid ministry, sacraments, and ecclesiastical authority is unbiblical; true apostolic continuity...	CONVICTIONAL	5	D	-	-	-	-		

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
doc-episcopal-polity-denial	Episcopal polity — bishops with authority over multiple local churches as a distinct tier above presbyters — lacks NT warrant; the NT uses 'bishop' (overseer)...	CONVICTIONAL	4	D	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-papal-supremacy-denial	Papal supremacy and infallibility — the Bishop of Rome as head of the universal Church and infallible in faith and morals when speaking ex cathedra — has no bi...	CONVICTIONAL	6	D	-	-	-	-		
doc-plurality-of-elders	Each local assembly should be led by a plurality of qualified elders (overseers/shepherds), not a single senior pastor; elders rule and shepherd jointly.	CONVICTIONAL	5	A	Y	Y	-	-		Y
doc-single-pastor-model-denial	The single-pastor / senior-pastor-as-CEO model lacks NT warrant; concentrating authority and teaching ministry in one man departs from the apostolic plurality...	CONVICTIONAL	4	D	Y	Y	-	-		Y
doc-women-elders-pastors-denial	The office of elder/overseer is reserved for qualified men; women are not to hold the eldership/teaching-pastor office over mixed adult assemblies.	CONVICTIONAL	4	D	Y	Y	-	-		
prc-women-teaching-mixed-adult-assemblies-denial	Women should not exercise authoritative teaching ministry over mixed adult assemblies in the gathered church (sermon, doctrinal instruction); women teaching wo...	CONVICTIONAL	3	D	Y	Y	-	-		Y
doc-congregational-polity-position	Congregational polity — final earthly authority resting in the gathered congregation under Christ, with elders leading and the assembly affirming — best preser...	IMPORTANT	3	A	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-deacons	Deacons are a NT office of servant-ministers handling practical care and administration in the local assembly, distinct from the teaching/oversight role of eld...	IMPORTANT	3	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		
doc-formal-ordination-rejection	Formal ordination as conferral of sacerdotal status or unique ministerial grace is rejected; recognition of elders/deacons by the local assembly with prayer an...	IMPORTANT	3	A	Y	Y	-	Y		Y
doc-presbyterian-polity-position	Presbyterian polity — graded courts (session, presbytery, general assembly) of teaching and ruling elders — has biblical merit (Acts 15) but tends toward over-...	IMPORTANT	3	D	Y	Y	-	-		
prc-women-in-diaconal-serving-roles	Women may serve in significant diaconal, hospitality, mercy, evangelism, women's ministry, children's ministry, missionary, and helping roles; gifting and call...	IMPORTANT	3	A	Y	Y	-	-		
prc-bivocational-vs-paid-ministry	Both bivocational eldership (tentmaking) and full-time supported ministry are biblically valid; neither is the only legitimate form, and Brethren tradition has...	PREFERENCE	1	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		Y
prc-formal-seminary-not-required-for-elders	Formal seminary or theological-college credentials are not biblically required for elder qualification; the NT criteria are character, doctrinal soundness, and...	PREFERENCE	1	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		Y
prc-small-family-style-assembly-preference	Small to mid-sized assemblies (sub-Dunbar) where members are known by name and elders can shepherd individually are preferable to mega-church structures.	PREFERENCE	1	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		Y

Church Discipline (4)

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
prc-church-discipline	Church discipline follows the Matthew 18 progression — private confrontation, small-group confrontation, assembly confrontation, removal — and is exercised in...	CONVICTIONAL	5	A	Y	Y	-	-		
prc-excommunication-as-final-step	Excommunication (removal from fellowship and the Lord's Table) is the final step of the Matthew 18 process for unrepentant sin, intended to provoke repentance...	CONVICTIONAL	4	A	Y	Y	-	-		
prc-restoration-after-discipline	When a disciplined member shows credible repentance, the assembly should restore them publicly, forgiving and reaffirming love.	CONVICTIONAL	4	A	Y	Y	-	-		
prc-formal-church-membership	Formal church membership — public covenanted commitment between believer and local assembly under elder oversight — is biblically warranted and prudentially es...	IMPORTANT	3	A	Y	Y	-	Y		

Worship Structure (4)

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
prc-women-silence-in-mixed-assembly	Women are not to take up authoritative speaking ministry (sermon, doctrinal teaching, leading the assembly) in the gathered mixed assembly (1 Cor 14:34-35; 1 T...	CONVICTIONAL	3	A	Y	Y	-	-		Y
prc-head-coverings-for-women-in-worship	Head coverings for women during prayer and prophecy in the gathered assembly (1 Cor 11) are practiced in Brethren tradition; the principle (creation-order dist...	PREFERENCE	1	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		Y
prc-liturgical-vs-spontaneous-worship	Both liturgical (set forms) and spontaneous (Spirit-led) worship are biblically defensible; the regulative principle requires that whatever is done in worship...	PREFERENCE	1	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		
prc-open-worship-open-ministry-meeting	An open worship/open ministry meeting (any qualified brother may rise as the Spirit leads to read, pray, give thanks, give a word, suggest a hymn) recovers NT...	PREFERENCE	1	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		Y

Inter-church Relations (4)

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
doc-ecumenism-with-non-trinitarian-groups-denial	Ecumenical or fellowship union with non-Trinitarian groups (Mormonism, Jehovah's Witnesses, Oneness Pentecostalism, Unitarianism) is rejected; these groups are...	ESSENTIAL	9	D	-	-	-	-		
doc-ecumenism-with-rome-denial	Formal ecumenical union with the Roman Catholic Church on shared sacramental, ministerial, and gospel ground is rejected so long as Rome maintains its post-Tri...	CONVICTIONAL	6	D	-	-	-	-		
doc-denominationalism-position	Denominationalism — the proliferation of human party-labels (Lutheran, Methodist, etc.) — is a regrettable historical reality, but recognition of distinct gosp...	IMPORTANT	2	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		Y
doc-parachurch-ministries	Parachurch ministries (mission agencies, campus ministries, mercy organisations, training institutions) are legitimate when they support and serve the local ch...	IMPORTANT	2	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		

Eschatology (20)

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
doc-bodily-resurrection-all	There will be a bodily resurrection of both the just and the unjust at the end of the age.	ESSENTIAL	10	A	-	-	-	-		
doc-eternal-conscious-torment	Unbelievers face eternal, conscious punishment in hell as the just judgment of a holy God.	ESSENTIAL	9	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-final-judgment	Christ will judge all people at his return — believers to eternal life, unbelievers to eternal punishment.	ESSENTIAL	10	A	-	-	-	-		
doc-full-preterism-denial	Full preterism — all prophecy including the second coming was fulfilled in AD 70 — is rejected as a denial of the bodily return of Christ.	ESSENTIAL	7	D	-	-	-	-		
doc-second-coming-bodily	Jesus Christ will return personally, visibly, audibly, and bodily to judge the living and the dead.	ESSENTIAL	10	A	-	-	-	-		
doc-universalism-denial	Universalism — the view that all people will ultimately be saved — is rejected as contrary to Scripture and historic Christianity.	ESSENTIAL	8	D	-	-	-	-		

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
doc-annihilationism-denial	Annihilationism (the view that the wicked are ultimately destroyed and cease to exist) is rejected as inconsistent with biblical teaching on eternal punishment.	CONVICTIONAL	5	D	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-imminence-no-date-setting	Christ's return is imminent and could occur at any time, but no one knows the day or the hour, and date-setting is forbidden.	CONVICTIONAL	4	A	-	-	-	-		
doc-intermediate-state	Believers who die are immediately present with the Lord, conscious and at rest, awaiting the resurrection of the body.	CONVICTIONAL	5	A	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-new-heavens-new-earth	God will create new heavens and a new earth in which righteousness dwells, the eternal home of the redeemed.	CONVICTIONAL	7	A	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-purgatory-denial	Purgatory — a post-mortem place of purification for believers — is rejected as having no biblical basis.	CONVICTIONAL	6	D	Y	-	-	-		
doc-future-for-israel	There is a future, visible salvation of ethnic Israel as a people when 'all Israel will be saved' (Rom 11:26).	IMPORTANT	3	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		Y
doc-prayers-for-dead-denial	Prayers for the dead are rejected as having no biblical warrant and as undermining the finality of judgment.	IMPORTANT	4	D	Y	-	-	-		
doc-soul-sleep-denial	Soul sleep — the view that the dead are unconscious until the resurrection — is rejected.	IMPORTANT	3	D	Y	Y	-	-		
doc-amillennialism	Amillennialism — the millennium is symbolic of the present church age between Christ's two advents — is a legitimate orthodox position.	PREFERENCE	1	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		
doc-dispensationalism	Classical dispensationalism — distinct programs for Israel and the Church across multiple dispensations — is a Brethren-origin system held loosely.	PREFERENCE	2	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		Y
doc-postmillennialism	Postmillennialism — Christ returns after a long age of gospel triumph — is a legitimate orthodox position though less likely.	PREFERENCE	1	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		
doc-posttrib-rapture	Post-tribulation rapture — the church is gathered to Christ at his visible return after the tribulation — has substantial scriptural support.	PREFERENCE	1	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		
doc-premillennialism	Premillennialism — Christ returns before a literal thousand-year reign on earth — is the position best supported by Revelation 20 and Brethren tradition.	PREFERENCE	2	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		Y
doc-pretrib-rapture	The pre-tribulation rapture — Christ secretly removes the church before a seven-year tribulation — is the historic Brethren-Darby position.	PREFERENCE	1	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		Y

Angelology (3)

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
doc-angels-exist	Angels exist as personal, created, ministering spirits who serve God and his elect.	CONVICTIONAL	4	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-fallen-angels	A portion of the angels fell into rebellion under Satan and are now demons opposed to God.	CONVICTIONAL	5	A	Y	-	-	-		
doc-guardian-angels	Guardian angels — angels assigned to particular believers — is a permissible but not dogmatically required position.	ADIAPHORA	1	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		

Demonology (4)

Cult Marker (15)

Tier: **ESSENTIAL** **CONVICTIONAL** **IMPORTANT** **PREFERENTIAL** **OPTIONAL** **PHI** **Major** **Minor** **Freedom** (0-10) V = Visit · P = Participate · S = Serve in ministry · Mb = Become member (if a church teaches the opposite) Cult = denial flags cult-grade error Brt = Brethren distinctive

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
cult-unitarian-trinity-denial	There is one God eternally existing in three coequal, coeternal Persons — Father, Son, and Holy Spirit.	ESSENTIAL	10	A	-	-	-	-	Y	

Heterodoxy Marker (9)

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
het-british-israelism	There is no biblical or genealogical basis for identifying modern Anglo-Saxons or Europeans as the lost tribes of Israel; Christian Identity racialism is heret...	CONVICTIONAL	6	D	-	-	-	-		
het-hyper-grace-antinomianism	Grace empowers believers to walk in holiness; the moral law remains binding as the rule of life for the believer, though not as the means of justification.	CONVICTIONAL	5	D	Y	Y	-	-		
het-icon-veneration	Veneration of icons (proskynesis) and prayers to saints are rejected as violating the second commandment and Christ's unique mediation.	CONVICTIONAL	5	D	Y	-	-	-		
het-nar-modern-apostles	The office of apostle in the foundational, Scripture-authoring sense ended with the apostles of Christ; modern 'apostles' and 'prophets' do not hold binding au...	CONVICTIONAL	6	D	-	-	-	-		
het-open-theism	God exhaustively foreknows all future events including free human choices; open theism's denial of God's exhaustive foreknowledge is rejected.	CONVICTIONAL	6	D	Y	-	-	-		
het-papal-infallibility	No human bishop or council possesses infallibility ex cathedra; Scripture alone is the infallible rule of faith and life.	CONVICTIONAL	6	D	Y	Y	-	-		
het-prosperity-gospel	The gospel is the good news of forgiveness of sins through Christ; God does not guarantee health and material wealth in this life to believers.	CONVICTIONAL	7	D	-	-	-	-		
het-rc-marian-dogmas	Mary was a sinner saved by grace like every other believer; she was not immaculately conceived, was not bodily assumed, and is not co-redemptrix.	CONVICTIONAL	5	D	Y	Y	-	-		
het-hyper-calvinism	The gospel is to be freely offered to all people; God commands all to repent and believe; hyper-Calvinism's denial of the free offer of the gospel is rejected.	IMPORTANT	4	D	Y	Y	-	-		

Spiritual Gifts (11)

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
prc-healing-in-atonement-guaranteed	Physical healing is guaranteed in the atonement for every believer in this life (such that lack of healing implies lack of faith).	CONVICTIONAL	6	D	-	-	-	-		
prc-hyper-charismatic-excess	Hyper-charismatic excess — slain in the Spirit as normative, holy laughter, Toronto Blessing phenomena, Bethel/NAR-style signs, fire tunnels, prophetic decrees...	CONVICTIONAL	6	D	-	-	-	-		
prc-modern-apostles	The office of Apostle (in the foundational sense — eyewitness of the risen Christ, sent with Christ's authority to lay the church's foundation) ceased with the...	CONVICTIONAL	6	A	-	-	-	-		
prc-prophecy-fallible-vs-binding	Any modern claim to prophecy must be tested by Scripture and is never binding on conscience the way Scripture is. New revelation that adds to or contradicts Sc...	CONVICTIONAL	6	A	-	-	-	-		
prc-tongues-as-evidence-of-salvation	Speaking in tongues is the necessary evidence of Spirit baptism and/or genuine salvation (classical Pentecostal initial-evidence doctrine).	CONVICTIONAL	6	D	-	-	-	-		
prc-word-of-faith	Word of Faith / 'name it and claim it' / decreeing and declaring as a creative force of human speech is a false gospel that confuses the creature with the Crea...	CONVICTIONAL	7	D	-	-	-	-	Y	

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
prc-cessationism	Cessationism: the miraculous sign gifts (apostleship, prophecy, tongues, miraculous healings) ceased with the apostolic age and the closing of the canon.	IMPORTANT	3	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		
prc-continuationism-orderly	Orderly continuationism: the Spirit may still distribute miraculous gifts today, but they must be tested by Scripture and exercised with order, not displacing...	IMPORTANT	3	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		
prc-deliverance-ministry	Demonic activity is real and Christians may need pastoral care including prayer for deliverance, but routinized 'deliverance ministry' that locates a demon beh...	IMPORTANT	3	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		
prc-divine-healing-open	God can and sometimes does heal in answer to prayer; healing is a sovereign mercy, not a guaranteed outcome.	IMPORTANT	3	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		
prc-tongues-real-languages	The biblical gift of tongues, as exhibited at Pentecost, is the Spirit-given ability to speak real human languages previously unknown to the speaker, for the s...	IMPORTANT	3	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		

Worship Style (7)

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
prc-seeker-sensitive-style	A seeker-sensitive worship design that downplays Scripture, sin, judgment, or the cross to attract unbelievers compromises worship's God-ward orientation.	IMPORTANT	3	D	Y	Y	-	-		
prc-sermon-centered-service	Christian worship rightly centers on the public reading and preaching of Scripture, alongside prayer, song, and the Lord's Supper.	IMPORTANT	3	A	Y	Y	Y	-		
prc-communion-frequency	Weekly observance of the Lord's Supper (the breaking of bread) is the New Testament and historic Brethren pattern.	PREFERENCE	2	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		Y
prc-congregational-singing	Congregational singing — the people of God lifting voices together — is the primary musical mode of Christian worship.	PREFERENCE	1	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		Y
prc-instrumentation	Instrumentation in worship is a matter of Christian liberty; simple instrumentation or a cappella worship is honored historically in Brethren practice but not...	PREFERENCE	1	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		Y
prc-liturgical-worship	A formal liturgy or lectionary is not commanded but is a permissible Christian-liberty matter when it preserves the gospel and Scripture's primacy.	PREFERENCE	1	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		
prc-psalm-and-hymn-singing	Singing psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs — including doctrinally rich historic hymns and biblically grounded modern songs — is good and commanded.	PREFERENCE	1	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		

Christian Ethics (10)

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
prc-pro-choice-position	Pro-choice ethics — that elective abortion is morally neutral or a Christian-liberty matter — is incompatible with biblical anthropology and the sixth commandm...	ESSENTIAL	9	D	-	-	-	-		
prc-sanctity-of-life	Human life bears the image of God from conception to natural death and is to be protected; intentional taking of innocent unborn human life (abortion) is sin.	ESSENTIAL	9	A	-	-	-	-		
prc-civil-disobedience	Christians submit to civil authority as God's servant, but must obey God rather than man when laws command sin or forbid commanded obedience.	CONVICTIONAL	7	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		
prc-euthanasia	Active euthanasia and assisted suicide are wrong; allowing natural death and refusing futile treatment is permitted.	CONVICTIONAL	7	D	-	-	-	-		

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
prc-honesty-and-restitution	Truth-telling, integrity in word, and restitution where wrong has been done are required Christian practice.	CONVICTIONAL	6	A	-	Y	-	-		
prc-pacifism-vs-just-war	Just-war and pacifist positions are both held by faithful Christians; Brethren tradition has historically leaned toward pacifism or non-combatant service while...	IMPORTANT	3	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		Y
prc-tobacco-and-recreational-drugs	Tobacco use is a matter of liberty with health-stewardship cautions; recreational drug use (including illegal drugs and intoxication-aimed cannabis) is sin and...	IMPORTANT	3	D	Y	Y	-	Y		
prc-alcohol	Alcohol consumption in moderation is a matter of Christian liberty; drunkenness is sin. Brethren tradition often counsels abstinence or strict moderation.	PREFERENCE	1	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		Y
prc-capital-punishment	Capital punishment for the most serious crimes, administered by lawful civil authority with due process, is permissible (open, with prudential cautions).	PREFERENCE	1	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		
prc-gambling	Gambling for gain at another's loss is unwise and contrary to neighbor-love; it is to be avoided as a regular practice.	PREFERENCE	1	D	Y	Y	Y	Y		

Marriage & Sexuality (10)

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
prc-gender-binary	God created humanity male and female; biological sex is binary, given by God, and immutable. Transgender ideology — that gender identity supersedes biological...	ESSENTIAL	9	A	-	-	-	-		
prc-marriage-one-man-one-woman	Marriage is a covenant union of one man and one woman, instituted by God at creation, intended for life, picturing Christ and the church.	ESSENTIAL	9	A	-	-	-	-		
prc-same-sex-sexual-activity	Same-sex sexual activity is sin, contrary to creation design and the consistent witness of Scripture; same-sex marriage is illegitimate.	ESSENTIAL	9	D	-	-	-	-		
prc-divorce-and-remarriage	Marriage is intended for life; divorce is permitted only in cases of sexual immorality (Matt 19) and abandonment by an unbelieving spouse (1 Cor 7); remarriage...	CONVICTIONAL	6	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		
prc-pornography	Pornography use is sin — adultery of the heart, exploitation of those in the industry, and corrosive of the marriage bed.	CONVICTIONAL	6	D	-	Y	-	-		
prc-pre-marital-sex-and-cohabitation	Sexual intimacy is reserved for marriage between one man and one woman; pre-marital sex (fornication) and unmarried cohabitation that includes sexual relations...	CONVICTIONAL	7	D	-	-	-	-		
prc-celibacy-as-gift	Singleness and celibacy are honorable callings, gifts from God, equally valued with marriage.	IMPORTANT	3	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		
prc-ivf-reproductive-tech	IVF and reproductive technologies are open with serious ethical concerns about embryo destruction, selection, and surrogacy detached from marriage.	IMPORTANT	3	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		
prc-contraception	Non-abortifacient contraception is a matter of Christian liberty; abortifacient methods (those that prevent implantation of a fertilized egg) are inconsistent...	PREFERENCE	1	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		
prc-modesty	Modesty in dress and self-presentation, without legalism, is a Christian virtue rooted in love of neighbor and godly self-restraint.	PREFERENCE	1	A	Y	Y	Y	Y		Y

Family & Discipleship (4)

ID	Statement	Tier	M	Pos	V	P	S	Mb	Cult	Brt
prc-lords-day-primacy	The first day of the week, the Lord's Day, is the appointed Christian gathering day in honor of Christ's resurrection.	IMPORTANT	3	A	Y	Y	Y	-		
prc-saturday-sabbatarianism	Mandatory Saturday Sabbath observance for Christians (Seventh-Day Adventism, Hebrew Roots) is rejected; the moral principle of one-in-seven rest stands, but bi...	IMPORTANT	3	D	-	-	-	-		
prc-christmas-easter-observance	Observance of Christmas and Easter (Resurrection Sunday) is permissible Christian liberty; Brethren tradition is divided, with many observing and some rejectin...	PREFERENCE	1	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		Y
prc-halloween	Active participation in occult or death-glorifying aspects of Halloween is rejected; harmless cultural participation (costumes, neighbor-friendly engagement) i...	PREFERENCE	1	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		
prc-lent-and-saint-days	Lent, Ash Wednesday, and saint-days are not commanded; Brethren typically do not observe. Personal fasting and reflection are commendable; treating the calenda...	PREFERENCE	1	O	Y	Y	Y	Y		Y

Detail — Filtered Entries

Tier filter: essential, convictional.

Bibliology

doc-ongoing-revelation-binding

Bibliology › Revelation

ESSENTIAL

No revelation given after the apostolic age binds the conscience or stands on par with Scripture.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 10/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox · **Brethren distinctive** · **Cult marker** · **Evangelism target if denied**

Rationale. The canon is closed; Hebrews 1:1-2 marks Christ as God's final word and the apostolic foundation is laid once (Eph 2:20). Brethren tradition holds this firmly.

Scripture: Hebrews 1:1-2, Ephesians 2:20, Jude 1:3, Revelation 22:18-19 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 1.1, 1689 Baptist Confession 1.1

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

This targets LDS (Book of Mormon), Watchtower, and groups elevating prophets' words to canon-equivalent. Charismatic 'words of knowledge' that don't claim canon-status are addressed in slot 5.

doc-scripture-final-authority

Bibliology › Authority

ESSENTIAL

Scripture is the final and supreme authority for the Church, above all tradition, councils, and personal experience.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 10/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox · **Brethren distinctive**

Rationale. Sola Scriptura is the formal principle of the Reformation and a defining Brethren commitment; tradition and experience are weighed by Scripture, never above it.

Scripture: Isaiah 8:20, Mark 7:8-13, Acts 17:11, 2 Timothy 3:16-17 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 1.10, 1689 Baptist Confession 1.10

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Adding revelation that binds conscience equally with Scripture (Catholic Magisterium, LDS, Watchtower) crosses into cult-marker territory under doc-ongoing-revelation-binding.

doc-scripture-inerrancy

Bibliology › Inerrancy

ESSENTIAL

Scripture in the original autographs is without error in all that it affirms, including history, science, and theology.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. If God cannot lie (Titus 1:2) and Scripture is His word, errors are categorically excluded; this is the Brethren-tradition baseline and the historic Protestant position.

Scripture: John 17:17, Psalm 19:7, Proverbs 30:5, Titus 1:2 | Confessions: Chicago Statement on Biblical Inerrancy, Westminster Confession 1.4-1.5

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Denial places one in liberal Protestantism; not cult-grade but undermines all downstream doctrine.

doc-scripture-infallibility

Bibliology › Infallibility

ESSENTIAL

Scripture cannot fail to accomplish what God intends and is incapable of misleading in matters of faith and practice.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Isaiah 55:11 and Matthew 5:18 anchor Scripture's unfailing efficacy; this is closely tied to inerrancy in Brethren teaching.

Scripture: Isaiah 55:11, Matthew 5:18, Luke 16:17 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 1.5, 1689 Baptist Confession 1.5

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

doc-scripture-inspiration-verbal-plenary

Bibliology › Inspiration

ESSENTIAL

All Scripture is verbally and plenary inspired by God, such that the very words of the original autographs are God-breathed.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 10/10 · Consensus: orthodox · **Cult marker**

Rationale. 2 Timothy 3:16 grounds inspiration in the text itself, not merely the authors or ideas; the Brethren tradition holds verbal-plenary inspiration as foundational to all other doctrine.

Scripture: 2 Timothy 3:16-17, 2 Peter 1:20-21, Matthew 5:18, John 10:35 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 1.2, 1689 Baptist Confession 1.2, Chicago Statement on Biblical Inerrancy

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Adding revelation on par with Scripture (Mormonism, Islam) is cult-grade; denial within professing Christianity is heterodox liberalism.

doc-scripture-sufficiency

Bibliology › Sufficiency

ESSENTIAL

Scripture is sufficient for faith, doctrine, and practice — no further revelation is needed for salvation or godliness.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: orthodox · Brethren distinctive

Rationale. 2 Timothy 3:16-17 explicitly equips the believer for every good work; sola Scriptura is foundational to Protestant and Brethren identity.

Scripture: 2 Timothy 3:16-17, 2 Peter 1:3, Deuteronomy 4:2, Revelation 22:18-19 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 1.6, 1689 Baptist Confession 1.6

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Key contrast with Roman Catholic Tradition+Magisterium and with charismatic ongoing-revelation claims that bind conscience.

doc-canon-66-books

Bibliology › Canon

CONVICTIONAL

The biblical canon comprises the 39 Old Testament and 27 New Testament books recognized by the Protestant tradition.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 6/10 · Consensus: divided

Rationale. The Hebrew canon Jesus referenced (Luke 24:44) and the apostolic-era reception of the 27 NT books form the basis; Brethren follow the Protestant 66-book canon.

Scripture: Luke 24:44, Romans 3:2, 2 Peter 3:15-16 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 1.2, 39 Articles 6

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Catholic and Orthodox include Apocrypha/Deuterocanon — divided across Christianity but settled within Protestantism.

doc-scripture-errantism-denial

Bibliology › Inerrancy

CONVICTIONAL

Errantism — the view that Scripture contains real errors in matters of history, science, or doctrine — is to be rejected.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 7/10 · Consensus: heterodox

Rationale. Errantism functionally subordinates Scripture to human judgment about which parts are reliable; Brethren tradition rejects this.

Scripture: John 10:35, Matthew 22:29-32, Psalm 119:160 | Confessions: Chicago Statement on Biblical Inerrancy

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Diagnostic entry — names the deviation. Many mainline Protestant churches teach this.

doc-scripture-perspicuity

Bibliology › Perspicuity

CONVICTIONAL

Scripture is sufficiently clear in matters necessary for salvation that any literate believer with the Spirit's help can grasp them.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 7/10 · Consensus: orthodox · Brethren distinctive

Rationale. Deuteronomy 6 and Psalm 119:130 assume ordinary believers can read and obey God's word; Brethren tradition strongly emphasizes lay reading.

Scripture: Deuteronomy 6:6-7, Psalm 119:105, Psalm 119:130, 2 Timothy 3:15 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 1.7

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Denial supports clericalism and gnostic readings; Brethren reject any 'priestly class' as sole interpreters.

Theology Proper

doc-divine-holiness

Theology Proper › Attributes

ESSENTIAL

God is utterly holy — set apart in moral purity and majestic transcendence.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Isaiah 6 and Revelation 4:8 frame holiness as God's central self-revelation; ground of all biblical ethics and worship.

Scripture: Isaiah 6:3, Leviticus 11:44, 1 Peter 1:15-16, Revelation 4:8 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 2.1

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Churches that minimize God's holiness in favor of love-only sentimentality fail this attribute test.

doc-divine-love

Theology Proper › Attributes

ESSENTIAL

God is love in His very essence, eternally loving within the Trinity and toward His creatures.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. 1 John 4:8,16 grounds love as constitutive of God's being; this love is never opposed to His holiness or justice but unified in the simple divine essence.

Scripture: 1 John 4:8, 1 John 4:16, John 3:16, Romans 5:8 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 2.1

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Doctrinally precise churches that lack visible love fail to embody this attribute even while affirming it.

doc-divine-omnipotence

Theology Proper › Attributes

ESSENTIAL

God is all-powerful, able to do all that He wills, limited only by His own nature.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Genesis 17:1, Job 42:2, and Luke 1:37 affirm omnipotence; God cannot do the logically impossible or contradict His character (e.g., lie, deny Himself).

Scripture: Genesis 17:1, Job 42:2, Jeremiah 32:17, Luke 1:37 | Confessions: Apostles' Creed, Westminster Confession 2.1

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

doc-divine-omniscience

Theology Proper › Attributes

ESSENTIAL

God knows all things, actual and possible, past, present, and future, exhaustively and eternally.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Psalm 139, Isaiah 46:9-10, and 1 John 3:20 affirm exhaustive divine knowledge including future free acts; Brethren and historic Protestantism affirm this.

Scripture: Psalm 139:1-6, Isaiah 46:9-10, 1 John 3:20, Hebrews 4:13 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 2.2, 1689 Baptist Confession 2.2

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Open theism denies exhaustive foreknowledge — see separate entry.

doc-divine-sovereignty

Theology Proper › Sovereignty

ESSENTIAL

God sovereignly rules over all things, working all events according to the counsel of His will.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Ephesians 1:11 and Daniel 4:35 ground exhaustive sovereignty; Brethren typically affirm sovereignty without taking strict-Calvinist exhaustive-determinism positions.

Scripture: Ephesians 1:11, Daniel 4:34-35, Psalm 115:3, Romans 11:36 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 3.1, Belgic Confession 13

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

The Calvinist-Arminian debate over the mode of sovereignty belongs in slot 3 (soteriology), not here.

doc-god-existence

Theology Proper › Existence

ESSENTIAL

The one true and living God exists eternally as the self-existent creator and sustainer of all things.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 10/10 · Consensus: orthodox · **Cult marker** · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. Genesis 1:1 and Romans 1:19-20 ground both special and general revelation of God's existence; the foundational confession of all monotheism.

Scripture: Genesis 1:1, Deuteronomy 6:4, Romans 1:19-20, Hebrews 11:6 | Confessions: Apostles' Creed, Nicene Creed, Westminster Confession 2.1

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Atheism is the denial; without this nothing else stands.

doc-modalism-denial

Theology Proper › Trinity

ESSENTIAL

Modalism — the view that Father, Son, and Spirit are merely modes or roles of one person — is to be rejected as heretical.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: heretical · **Cult marker** · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. The simultaneous distinction of persons at Christ's baptism (Matt 3:16-17) and the Son praying to the Father refute modalism; condemned formally in the early church.

Scripture: Matthew 3:16-17, John 17:5, John 14:16 | Confessions: Athanasian Creed, Nicene Creed

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Oneness Pentecostalism (UPCI, T.D. Jakes historically) is the modern modalist movement — diagnostic for cult-adjacent classification.

doc-trinity

Theology Proper › Trinity

ESSENTIAL

God exists eternally as one being in three co-equal, co-eternal, distinct persons: Father, Son, and Holy Spirit.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 10/10 · Consensus: orthodox · **Cult marker** · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. Matthew 28:19, 2 Corinthians 13:14, and the Johannine prologue ground the triune confession; the Nicene-Chalcedonian definition is the orthodox boundary.

Scripture: Matthew 28:19, 2 Corinthians 13:14, John 1:1-14, John 14:16-17, 1 Peter 1:2 | Confessions: Nicene Creed, Athanasian Creed, Chalcedonian Definition, Westminster Confession 2.3

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Trinity-denial is the universal cult marker — Watchtower, LDS, Oneness Pentecostalism, Unitarianism.

doc-tritheism-denial

Theology Proper › Trinity

ESSENTIAL

Tritheism — the view that the three persons are three separate gods — is to be rejected as heretical.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 9/10 · **Consensus:** heretical · **Cult marker** · **Evangelism target if denied**

Rationale. The Shema (Deut 6:4) and the consistent monotheism of Scripture forbid three-gods readings; orthodox Trinity is one being, three persons.

Scripture: Deuteronomy 6:4, Isaiah 45:5, 1 Corinthians 8:6 | **Confessions:** Athanasian Creed, Nicene Creed

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

LDS theology (separate beings, exalted men become gods) is functionally tritheist/polytheist — clear cult marker.

doc-divine-aseity

Theology Proper › Attributes

CONVICTIONAL

God is self-existent, deriving His being from nothing outside Himself.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 7/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox

Rationale. Exodus 3:14 ('I AM') and John 5:26 ground God's life-in-Himself; aseity distinguishes the Creator from all creatures.

Scripture: Exodus 3:14, John 5:26, Acts 17:25 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 2.2, Belgic Confession 1

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Process theology denies aseity; LDS doctrine of God-as-exalted-man also denies it.

doc-divine-immutability

Theology Proper › Attributes

CONVICTIONAL

God is unchanging in His being, perfections, purposes, and promises.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 7/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox

Rationale. Malachi 3:6, James 1:17, and Hebrews 13:8 ground immutability; anthropomorphic 'repentance' texts describe relational change toward changed creatures, not God's essence.

Scripture: Malachi 3:6, Numbers 23:19, James 1:17, Hebrews 13:8 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 2.1, 1689 Baptist Confession 2.1

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Process theology and open theism deny strong immutability.

doc-divine-omnipresence

Theology Proper › Attributes

CONVICTIONAL

God is fully present everywhere, not bounded by space, while remaining distinct from creation.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 7/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Psalm 139:7-10 and Jeremiah 23:24 ground omnipresence; this rules out both deism (absent God) and pantheism (God = creation).

Scripture: Psalm 139:7-10, Jeremiah 23:23-24, Acts 17:27-28 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 2.1, Belgic Confession 1

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

doc-open-theism-denial

Theology Proper › Attributes

CONVICTIONAL

Open Theism — the view that God does not exhaustively know future free human actions — is to be rejected.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 7/10 · Consensus: heterodox

Rationale. Isaiah 46:9-10 grounds God's declaring 'the end from the beginning' as His distinctive deity; specific predictive prophecies (e.g., Cyrus by name, Peter's denial) require exhaustive foreknowledge.

Scripture: Isaiah 46:9-10, Isaiah 44:28-45:1, Matthew 26:34, Acts 2:23 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 2.2

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Diagnostic entry for open theism (Pinnock, Boyd, Sanders). Heterodox, not formally heretical, but redefines God.

Christology

doc-bodily-ascension

Christology › Work

ESSENTIAL

Christ ascended bodily into heaven forty days after His resurrection.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Acts 1:9-11 and Luke 24:50-51 record the bodily ascension; required for the heavenly session and the promise of bodily return.

Scripture: Luke 24:50-51, Acts 1:9-11, Ephesians 4:8-10, 1 Timothy 3:16 | Confessions: Apostles' Creed, Nicene Creed

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

doc-christ-sinlessness

Christology › Person

ESSENTIAL

Jesus Christ was without sin in His thoughts, words, and deeds throughout His earthly life.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 10/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox · **Evangelism target if denied**

Rationale. Hebrews 4:15, 2 Corinthians 5:21, and 1 Peter 2:22 affirm Christ's sinlessness; required for substitutionary atonement.

Scripture: Hebrews 4:15, 2 Corinthians 5:21, 1 Peter 2:22, 1 John 3:5 | **Confessions:** Chalcedonian Definition, Westminster Confession 8.2

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Denial collapses the gospel — a sinful Christ cannot save.

doc-christ-sole-mediator

Christology › Mediation

ESSENTIAL

Christ is the sole mediator between God and humanity; no saint, angel, or Mary mediates access to God.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 9/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox · **Brethren distinctive**

Rationale. 1 Timothy 2:5 explicitly names one mediator; this is a hallmark Brethren and Reformation conviction against Marian and saintly intercession as mediation.

Scripture: 1 Timothy 2:5, Hebrews 7:25, Hebrews 9:15, John 14:6 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 8.1, 39 Articles 22

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Roman Catholic and Eastern Orthodox practice of saintly/Marian intercession violates this; visiting is fine, membership/serving is not.

doc-eternal-sonship

Christology › Person

ESSENTIAL

The Son is eternally the Son — co-eternal and co-equal with the Father — not adopted or begun in time.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 9/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox

Rationale. John 1:1-2, John 17:5, and Hebrews 1:8 affirm the Son's pre-existence as Son; Nicene 'eternally begotten of the Father' is the orthodox boundary.

Scripture: John 1:1-2, John 17:5, Colossians 1:15-17, Hebrews 1:8 | **Confessions:** Nicene Creed, Athanasian Creed

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Adoptionism (Son became Son at baptism/incarnation) is heretical; some evangelicals (e.g., MacArthur formerly) flirted with incarnational sonship but later corrected.

doc-hypostatic-union

Christology › Person

ESSENTIAL

Christ is one person in two natures — fully divine and fully human — without confusion, change, division, or separation.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. The Chalcedonian Definition codifies the biblical witness; the natures are united in the one person of the Son without mixing or separating.

Scripture: John 1:14, Philippians 2:6-8, Colossians 2:9, 1 Timothy 2:5 | Confessions: Chalcedonian Definition, Athanasian Creed

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Excludes Nestorianism (two persons), Eutychianism/monophysitism (mixed nature), Apollinarianism (incomplete humanity).

doc-vicarious-atonement

Christology › Work

ESSENTIAL

Christ died as a substitute, bearing the penalty for the sins of His people in their place.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 10/10 · Consensus: orthodox · Cult marker · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. Isaiah 53, Romans 3:25, 2 Corinthians 5:21, and 1 Peter 2:24 ground penal substitution; the heart of the Brethren-tradition gospel.

Scripture: Isaiah 53:4-6, Romans 3:25, 2 Corinthians 5:21, 1 Peter 2:24, 1 John 2:2 | Confessions: Heidelberg Catechism Q37-39, Westminster Confession 8.5, 1689 Baptist Confession 8.5

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Denial of penal substitution (e.g., Christus Victor only, moral influence only, denial of wrath-bearing) functionally guts the gospel.

doc-virgin-birth

Christology › Person

ESSENTIAL

Jesus Christ was conceived by the Holy Spirit and born of the virgin Mary.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Matthew 1:18-25 and Luke 1:26-35 explicitly teach virginal conception; foundational to incarnation and a historic creedal essential.

Scripture: Matthew 1:18-25, Luke 1:26-35, Isaiah 7:14 | Confessions: Apostles' Creed, Nicene Creed

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Liberal Protestantism often denies; this is one of the fundamentals of the fundamentalist-modernist controversy.

doc-christ-session-exaltation

Christology › Work

CONVICTIONAL

The risen Christ is exalted at the right hand of the Father, reigning and interceding for His people.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 8/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Hebrews 1:3, Hebrews 7:25, and Romans 8:34 ground Christ's heavenly session and intercession.

Scripture: Hebrews 1:3, Hebrews 7:25, Romans 8:34, Ephesians 1:20-22 | Confessions: Apostles' Creed, Westminster Confession 8.4

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

doc-kenoticism-denial

Christology › Person

CONVICTIONAL

Kenoticism — the view that Christ surrendered or gave up divine attributes in the incarnation — is to be rejected.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 6/10 · Consensus: heterodox

Rationale. Philippians 2:6-7's 'emptying' refers to taking the form of a servant, not to losing deity; Colossians 2:9 affirms the fullness of deity dwells in Christ bodily even now.

Scripture: Philippians 2:6-7, Colossians 2:9, John 1:14, Hebrews 1:3 | Confessions: Chalcedonian Definition

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Functional kenoticism (Christ used divine attributes voluntarily) can be acceptable; ontological kenoticism is heterodox.

Pneumatology

doc-spirit-full-deity

Pneumatology › Person

ESSENTIAL

The Holy Spirit is fully and truly God, co-equal and co-eternal with the Father and the Son.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 10/10 · Consensus: orthodox · Cult marker · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. Acts 5:3-4 (lying to the Spirit = lying to God), 1 Corinthians 3:16, and the baptismal formula (Matt 28:19) ground the Spirit's deity.

Scripture: Acts 5:3-4, 1 Corinthians 3:16, Matthew 28:19, 2 Corinthians 13:14 | Confessions: Nicene-Constantinopolitan Creed, Athanasian Creed

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Watchtower denies Spirit's deity and personhood — a primary cult marker.

doc-spirit-indwelling

Pneumatology › Work

ESSENTIAL

The Holy Spirit indwells every true believer permanently from the moment of regeneration.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Romans 8:9 ('if anyone does not have the Spirit of Christ, he does not belong to him') makes indwelling the mark of every Christian; John 14:16-17 promises permanence.

Scripture: Romans 8:9-11, John 14:16-17, 1 Corinthians 6:19, Ephesians 1:13-14 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 13.1, 1689 Baptist Confession 13.1

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Some sacramental traditions teach Spirit-reception only via baptism/confirmation by clergy — Brethren reject this strongly.

doc-spirit-personhood

Pneumatology › Person

ESSENTIAL

The Holy Spirit is a personal being — possessing intellect, will, and emotion — not an impersonal force or energy.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 10/10 · Consensus: orthodox · Cult marker · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. John 14-16 attributes teaching, willing, grieving, and personal pronouns to the Spirit; Ephesians 4:30 ('grieve not the Spirit') requires personhood.

Scripture: John 14:26, John 16:13-14, Acts 13:2, Romans 8:26-27, Ephesians 4:30 | Confessions: Nicene-Constantinopolitan Creed

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Watchtower's 'active force' doctrine fails this directly.

doc-spirit-regeneration

Pneumatology › Work

ESSENTIAL

The Holy Spirit is the agent of regeneration, granting new birth to those dead in sin.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. John 3:5-8 and Titus 3:5 ground regeneration as the Spirit's work; without the Spirit's quickening, no one can come to Christ.

Scripture: John 3:5-8, Titus 3:5, Ezekiel 36:26-27, John 6:63 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 10.1-10.2, 1689 Baptist Confession 10

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

doc-blasphemy-of-spirit

Pneumatology › Sin

CONVICTIONAL

Blasphemy against the Holy Spirit — final, hardened rejection of His witness to Christ — is unforgivable.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 6/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox

Rationale. Mark 3:28-30 and Matthew 12:31-32 teach the unpardonable sin in the context of attributing Christ's Spirit-empowered works to Satan; Brethren tradition treats this seriously but pastorally, with assurance that those who fear they have committed it likely have not.

Scripture: Mark 3:28-30, Matthew 12:31-32, Hebrews 6:4-6, 1 John 5:16 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 17.3

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	Y	Member	Y
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	-

Pastoral application matters more than precise definition — anxious sinners seeking forgiveness have not committed this sin.

doc-spirit-baptism-at-conversion

Pneumatology › Work

CONVICTIONAL

Spirit baptism (being baptized into the body of Christ by the Spirit) occurs at conversion for every believer, not as a subsequent second blessing.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 6/10 · **Consensus:** divided · **Brethren distinctive**

Rationale. 1 Corinthians 12:13 says 'we were all baptized by one Spirit into one body' — universal to believers, not a post-conversion experience; Brethren tradition holds this against second-blessing Pentecostalism.

Scripture: 1 Corinthians 12:13, Ephesians 4:5, Romans 6:3-4, Galatians 3:27 | **Confessions:** 1689 Baptist Confession 13.1

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Pentecostal/charismatic 'second-blessing' Spirit-baptism (often with tongues as initial evidence) is the divide. Cessationism details belong in slot 5.

doc-spirit-illumination

Pneumatology › Work

CONVICTIONAL

The Holy Spirit illumines Scripture to believers, enabling spiritual understanding of God's word.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 7/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox

Rationale. 1 Corinthians 2:10-14 and 1 John 2:27 ground illumination; the Spirit does not give new revelation but opens the believer's mind to the inscripturated word.

Scripture: 1 Corinthians 2:10-14, 1 John 2:27, Ephesians 1:17-18, John 16:13 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 1.6

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Crucial distinction: illumination opens what is written; it does not add new revelation that binds conscience.

doc-spirit-sealing

Pneumatology › Work

CONVICTIONAL

The Holy Spirit seals every believer as God's possession, guaranteeing their final inheritance.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 7/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Ephesians 1:13-14 and 4:30 explicitly describe the Spirit as the seal and down-payment; Brethren tradition affirms this as ground of eternal security.

Scripture: Ephesians 1:13-14, Ephesians 4:30, 2 Corinthians 1:21-22 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 18.2

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Connected to eternal security — see slot 3 soteriology for fuller treatment.

Anthropology

doc-adam-historical

Anthropology › Historicity

CONVICTIONAL

Adam and Eve were real historical persons, the first human pair, from whom all humanity descends; they were specially created and not the product of unguided evolution.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 7/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Required by Pauline federal-headship theology (Rom 5; 1 Cor 15); denial collapses the parallel between First and Last Adam and undermines original sin.

Scripture: Genesis 1-3, Romans 5:12-21, 1 Corinthians 15:21-22, 1 Corinthians 15:45, Luke 3:38, 1 Timothy 2:13-14 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 4.2, Belgic Confession Article 14

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Mythologizing Adam (as in some theistic-evolution frameworks) erodes the gospel's historical scaffolding. Age of earth is separate question.

doc-gender-binary

Anthropology › Created Order

CONVICTIONAL

God created humanity male and female as a fixed binary rooted in creation; biological sex and gender identity are coherent and not subject to self-determined redefinition.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 7/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Genesis 1:27 grounds gender in creation, reaffirmed by Christ (Matt 19:4); denial undermines marriage, sexuality, and the Creator-creature distinction.

Scripture: Genesis 1:27, Genesis 2:18-24, Matthew 19:4-6, Mark 10:6, Romans 1:26-27 | Confessions: Nashville Statement, Westminster Confession 24

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Pastoral compassion required toward those with dysphoria; doctrinal clarity not negotiable. Increasingly a status confessionis issue in modern West.

doc-image-of-god

Anthropology › Imago Dei

CONVICTIONAL

All human beings are created in the image of God (imago Dei), bearing inherent dignity, moral agency, rationality, and capacity for relationship with God, irrespective of age, ability, ethnicity, or stage of development.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 7/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Foundational to Genesis 1 anthropology and to a coherent Christian ethic of life, dignity, and personhood; affirmed across Brethren tradition and historic Protestant orthodoxy.

Scripture: Genesis 1:26-27, Genesis 9:6, Psalm 8:4-6, James 3:9, Colossians 3:10 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 4.2, Belgic Confession Article 14, Heidelberg Catechism Q6

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Denial typically signals deeper anthropological distortion (e.g., racism, eugenics, transhumanism); marred by sin but not erased.

Hamartiology

doc-fall-historical

Hamartiology › The Fall

CONVICTIONAL

The Fall was a real historical event in which Adam, as covenant head, disobeyed God, plunging humanity and the created order into sin, death, and corruption.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 8/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. The historicity of the Fall is necessary for a coherent doctrine of redemption; without a real Fall, there is no real need for a real Redeemer.

Scripture: Genesis 3, Romans 5:12-19, Romans 8:20-22, 1 Corinthians 15:21-22 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 6, Belgic Confession Article 14

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

doc-inability-of-fallen-man

Hamartiology › Spiritual Inability

CONVICTIONAL

Fallen humans, apart from the Spirit's prior work, are unable to please God, repent, or believe savingly; the natural man cannot receive the things of the Spirit.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 6/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Direct corollary of total depravity; affirmed across Reformation traditions including Brethren formation, even where prevenient grace (rather than effectual call) is the mechanism.

Scripture: John 6:44, John 6:65, Romans 8:7-8, 1 Corinthians 2:14, Ephesians 2:1 | Confessions: Canons of Dort 3/4.3, Westminster Confession 9.3

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

doc-original-sin

Hamartiology › Original Sin

CONVICTIONAL

All human beings are born with a sinful nature inherited from Adam, sharing in his guilt and corruption, and are by nature objects of divine wrath.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 8/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Affirmed across Brethren tradition, Reformation confessions, and Augustinian consensus; required by Romans 5 and Ephesians 2:1-3.

Scripture: Psalm 51:5, Romans 5:12-19, Ephesians 2:1-3, Romans 3:9-23, Job 14:4 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 6.2-6.3, Heidelberg Catechism Q7-Q8, 39 Articles Article 9

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Denial trends toward Pelagianism and ultimately works-salvation; tightly linked to need for substitutionary atonement.

doc-sin-as-transgression

Hamartiology › Definition of Sin

CONVICTIONAL

Sin is any want of conformity to, or transgression of, the law of God — in thought, word, deed, and disposition — and is fundamentally an offense against God's holy character, not merely against neighbour.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 7/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. 1 John 3:4 defines sin as lawlessness; without an objective divine standard, sin becomes therapeutic dysfunction and the cross becomes incoherent.

Scripture: 1 John 3:4, Romans 7:7-13, James 2:10-11, James 4:17, Psalm 51:4 | Confessions: Westminster Shorter Catechism Q14, Heidelberg Catechism Q3-Q5

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Modern therapeutic redefinitions of sin as 'brokenness' alone are insufficient — sin is also guilt before God.

doc-total-depravity

Hamartiology › Depravity

CONVICTIONAL

Sin has corrupted every faculty of fallen man — mind, will, affections, body — such that no part is untouched and unaided man cannot save himself or initiate saving faith.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 7/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Brethren tradition affirms total depravity (extent, not degree) even while typically rejecting other points of high Calvinism; necessary against Pelagian/semi-Pelagian optimism about human nature.

Scripture: Romans 3:10-18, Jeremiah 17:9, Ephesians 2:1-5, John 6:44, 1 Corinthians 2:14, Romans 8:7-8 | Confessions: Canons of Dort 3/4.1-4, Westminster Confession 6.4, Heidelberg Catechism Q8

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Total depravity does not mean utter wickedness in every act; it means no part is untouched and salvation is wholly of grace.

Soteriology

doc-glorification

Soteriology › Glorification

ESSENTIAL

At Christ's return, believers will be raised bodily, transformed, and glorified — the final consummation of salvation in resurrection bodies free from sin and decay.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. The 'already-not yet' completion of salvation; Brethren tradition has historically been strong on bodily resurrection and final glorification.

Scripture: Romans 8:30, 1 Corinthians 15:42-57, 1 John 3:2, Philippians 3:21, Romans 8:18-23 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 32-33, Apostles' Creed

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

doc-imputed-righteousness

Soteriology › Justification

ESSENTIAL

In justification, the active and passive righteousness of Christ is imputed (reckoned, credited) to the believer, so that the believer stands clothed in Christ's perfect obedience before God.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: orthodox · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. The 'great exchange' (2 Cor 5:21) is the heart of the gospel; both sides — sin imputed to Christ, righteousness imputed to believer — must be held.

Scripture: 2 Corinthians 5:21, Romans 4:3-8, Romans 5:19, Philippians 3:9, Jeremiah 23:6 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 11.1-11.3, Heidelberg Catechism Q60-Q61

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Some New Perspective on Paul advocates deny imputation specifically; this remains a serious doctrinal error.

doc-justification-forensic

Soteriology › Justification

ESSENTIAL

Justification is a forensic, declarative act of God in which He pardons sinners and accounts them righteous in His sight — not on the basis of any inherent change, but solely on account of Christ's imputed righteousness received by faith.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: orthodox · Cult marker · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. Forensic ('declared' not 'made') justification is the Reformation insight against Roman infusion; denial moves toward sacramental works-salvation.

Scripture: Romans 3:21-26, Romans 4:5, Romans 5:1, Romans 5:18-19, 2 Corinthians 5:21, Philippians 3:9 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 11.1, Heidelberg Catechism Q60, Belgic Confession Article 22-23

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Distinct from sanctification: justification is once-for-all, declarative; sanctification is progressive, transformative.

doc-pelagianism-denial

Soteriology › Denied Errors

ESSENTIAL

Pelagianism — the teaching that humans are born morally neutral, unaffected by Adam’s sin, and able to choose God and obey His law by natural ability — is a denied heresy.

Position: DENY · **Martyrdom:** 9/10 · **Consensus:** heretical · **Evangelism target if denied**

Rationale. Condemned at Council of Carthage (418), Council of Ephesus (431); incompatible with Romans 5, Ephesians 2, and the necessity of the cross.

Scripture: Romans 5:12-19, Ephesians 2:1-5, Psalm 51:5, Romans 3:10-12, John 6:44 | **Confessions:** Council of Carthage 418, Canons of Dort 3/4, Westminster Confession 6

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Note: 'denied' here means I deny Pelagianism. Field semantics: personal_position=deny means I reject the named error. Heretical not cult-grade because not always salvation-collapsing in every form, but typically is.

doc-penal-substitution

Soteriology › Atonement

ESSENTIAL

The atonement is penal in nature: Christ bore the just punishment and divine wrath that sinners deserved, satisfying God's justice and propitiating His wrath.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 9/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox · **Evangelism target if denied**

Rationale. Propitiation language (hilasmos/hilasterion) requires a wrath-bearing substitute; rejection of penal substitution typically reduces the cross to example or moral influence.

Scripture: Romans 3:25, 1 John 2:2, 1 John 4:10, Hebrews 2:17, Isaiah 53:10, Galatians 3:13 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 8.4-8.5, 39 Articles Article 31

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Other models (Christus Victor, recapitulation) are valid complements but not substitutes; PSA must remain central.

doc-pluralism-inclusivism-denial

Soteriology › Denied Errors

ESSENTIAL

Religious pluralism (all paths lead to God) and Christian inclusivism (people may be saved through other religions because of Christ without explicit faith) are denied; explicit faith in the historical Jesus Christ is necessary for salvation.

Position: DENY · Martyrdom: 10/10 · Consensus: heretical · Cult marker · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. John 14:6, Acts 4:12, Rom 10:13-17 require named-Christ faith; pluralism collapses the cross's necessity; inclusivism (Rahner-style 'anonymous Christians') softens but ultimately undermines missionary urgency.

Scripture: John 14:6, Acts 4:12, Romans 10:9-17, 1 Timothy 2:5, 1 John 5:11-12, John 3:18, John 3:36 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 10.4, Heidelberg Catechism Q20

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

WCF 10.4 narrowly leaves room for elect-infants/incapable; that is not pluralism. The unevangelized adult question is hard but the answer is missionary urgency, not pluralism.

doc-prosperity-gospel-denial

Soteriology › Denied Errors

ESSENTIAL

The prosperity gospel — that faith in Christ guarantees material wealth, physical health, and earthly success, often via 'sowing' financial seed — is a denied false gospel.

Position: DENY · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: heretical · Cult marker · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. Distorts the cross, exploits the vulnerable, and replaces the kingdom with consumerism; treats God as cosmic vending-machine. Especially destructive in Indian/Global-South contexts.

Scripture: 1 Timothy 6:5-10, 2 Timothy 3:1-5, Philippians 4:11-13, Matthew 6:19-21, Mark 8:34-36, James 5:1-6

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Soft prosperity-adjacent teaching ('your best life now') is a milder form but on the same trajectory; treat as evangelism field.

doc-repentance

Soteriology › Conversion

ESSENTIAL

Repentance — a Spirit-given change of mind toward sin and toward God, issuing in turning from sin to Christ — is integral to saving conversion, never separable from saving faith.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: orthodox · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. Christ's first preaching was 'repent and believe' (Mark 1:15); a 'gospel' without repentance is not the biblical gospel.

Scripture: Mark 1:15, Acts 2:38, Acts 17:30, Acts 20:21, 2 Corinthians 7:10, Luke 13:3 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 15, Heidelberg Catechism Q88-Q90

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Disputes about 'how much repentance is required' (Lordship vs. Free Grace) are in-house; total absence of repentance is not.

doc-sola-fide

Soteriology › Five Solas

ESSENTIAL

Justification is by faith alone (sola fide) — faith being the empty hand that receives Christ's imputed righteousness; works are the necessary fruit, never the ground, of justification.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 10/10 · Consensus: orthodox · Cult marker · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. Articulus stantis et cadentis ecclesiae per the Reformers; central in Brethren tradition; explicitly denied by Trent and modern works-systems.

Scripture: Romans 3:28, Romans 4:1-8, Galatians 2:16, Galatians 3:11, Ephesians 2:8-9, Philippians 3:9 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 11, Heidelberg Catechism Q60-Q62, Augsburg Confession Article 4

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

James 2 harmonizes: faith without works is dead, but works are vindicating evidence, not justifying ground.

doc-sola-gratia

Soteriology › Five Solas

ESSENTIAL

Salvation is by grace alone (sola gratia) — wholly God's unmerited favour, never earned, contributed to, or co-purchased by human effort, ritual, or pedigree.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 10/10 · Consensus: orthodox · Cult marker · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. Cornerstone of biblical and Reformation soteriology; affirmed by Brethren tradition; denial corrupts the gospel itself.

Scripture: Ephesians 2:8-9, Romans 3:24, Romans 11:6, Titus 3:5-7, 2 Timothy 1:9 | Confessions: Canons of Dort 2.7, Westminster Confession 11, Heidelberg Catechism Q60

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Denial = false gospel (Gal 1:8-9). Cult-grade when grace is replaced by works/sacraments/secret knowledge.

doc-solus-christus

Soteriology › Five Solas

ESSENTIAL

Salvation is in Christ alone (solus Christus); there is no other name under heaven by which men must be saved, no other mediator between God and man.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 10/10 · Consensus: orthodox · **Cult marker** · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. Direct biblical claim (John 14:6; Acts 4:12; 1 Tim 2:5); denial collapses into pluralism or inclusivism.

Scripture: John 14:6, Acts 4:12, 1 Timothy 2:5, 1 John 5:11-12, Hebrews 7:25 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 8, Heidelberg Catechism Q29-Q31

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

doc-substitutionary-atonement

Soteriology › Atonement

ESSENTIAL

Christ died as a substitute in the place of sinners, bearing the penalty due for their sin so that they might be reconciled to God.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: orthodox · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. Substitutionary logic pervades Scripture from Passover lamb to Isaiah 53 to NT atonement language; central to Brethren preaching.

Scripture: Isaiah 53:4-6, 1 Peter 2:24, 1 Peter 3:18, 2 Corinthians 5:21, Romans 5:8, Galatians 3:13 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 8.4-8.5, Heidelberg Catechism Q37-Q40

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

doc-works-righteousness-denial

Soteriology › Denied Errors

ESSENTIAL

Works-righteousness — any system in which human merit, sacraments, ritual, law-keeping, or moral effort partly or wholly grounds justification before God — is a denied false gospel.

Position: DENY · Martyrdom: 10/10 · Consensus: heretical · **Cult marker** · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. Galatians 1 anathematizes any other gospel; works-righteousness directly negates sola gratia and sola fide. Cult-grade.

Scripture: Galatians 1:6-9, Galatians 2:16, Galatians 3:1-14, Romans 3:20, Romans 4:4-5, Ephesians 2:8-9, Titus 3:5 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 11, Heidelberg Catechism Q60-Q62, Augsburg Confession Article 4

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Cult-grade because it inverts the gospel itself. Includes Tridentine Roman, Eastern works-synergy, sectarian legalism, etc.

doc-adoption

Soteriology › Adoption

CONVICTIONAL

By adoption, those justified are received into the family of God, granted the privileges, name, and inheritance of sons through union with Christ and indwelling of the Spirit of adoption.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 6/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Adoption is the relational summit of soteriology (Rom 8; Gal 4); critical pastoral doctrine for assurance and identity.

Scripture: Romans 8:14-17, Galatians 4:4-7, Ephesians 1:5, John 1:12, 1 John 3:1-2 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 12, Heidelberg Catechism Q33

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

doc-antinomianism-denial

Soteriology › Denied Errors

CONVICTIONAL

Antinomianism — that grace abolishes any binding role for God's moral law in the Christian life, so that obedience is optional or irrelevant — is a denied error.

Position: DENY · Martyrdom: 7/10 · Consensus: heterodox

Rationale. Romans 6 explicitly condemns 'continue in sin that grace may abound'; the Spirit writes the law on the believer's heart (Jer 31; Heb 8). Free Grace circles sometimes drift here.

Scripture: Romans 6:1-2, Romans 6:15, Romans 8:4, Galatians 5:13-25, Titus 2:11-14, 1 John 2:3-6, 1 John 3:7-10 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 19, Heidelberg Catechism Q86

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Distinct from confessional 'third use of the law' debates; antinomianism proper denies any binding moral norm.

doc-conversion

Soteriology › Conversion

CONVICTIONAL

Conversion is the conscious human response to the gospel — repentance and faith — by which the regenerated sinner turns from sin to Christ; both gift of God and act of the believer.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 6/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Conversion is the human side of regeneration's divine work; Brethren tradition emphasizes a definite, datable conversion in many testimonies, while not making the moment of decision the saving thing.

Scripture: Acts 3:19, 1 Thessalonians 1:9, Acts 26:18, Acts 11:21 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 10-11

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

doc-legalism-denial

Soteriology › Denied Errors

CONVICTIONAL

Legalism — adding human rules to God's commands as conditions of acceptance, fellowship, or sanctification, or treating obedience as the ground rather than fruit of grace — is a denied error.

Position: DENY · **Martyrdom:** 6/10 · **Consensus:** heterodox

Rationale. Christ's strongest rebukes were against legalists (Matt 23); Brethren tradition has historically been alert to legalism even while sometimes drifting into it culturally (dress codes, separatism rules). Particular pastoral concern.

Scripture: Matthew 23:1-28, Galatians 2:11-21, Galatians 5:1-6, Colossians 2:16-23, Mark 7:1-13

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Diagnostic mismatch this baseline is built to expose: doctrinally-precise churches often legalism-positive, fruit-rich churches often loose. Both errors. The goal is grace + truth + love.

doc-perseverance-eternal-security

Soteriology › Perseverance

CONVICTIONAL

Those truly born again will be kept by the power of God through faith unto final salvation; genuine believers cannot ultimately and finally fall away.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 6/10 · **Consensus:** divided · **Brethren distinctive**

Rationale. Brethren tradition strongly affirms eternal security (John 10:28-29; Rom 8:38-39; Phil 1:6); apparent apostates are understood as never genuinely regenerate (1 John 2:19).

Scripture: John 10:27-29, Romans 8:30-39, Philippians 1:6, 1 Peter 1:5, 1 John 2:19, Jude 24 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 17, Canons of Dort 5

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Wesleyan/classical Arminian denial is a real historic Protestant position; in-house but consequential pastorally. Distinguish from 'carnal Christian' / cheap-grace abuse.

doc-progressive-sanctification

Soteriology › Sanctification

CONVICTIONAL

Sanctification is the progressive, Spirit-wrought work of conforming believers to the image of Christ — distinct from justification but inseparable from it; engaged through means of grace and Spirit-empowered effort.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 7/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox

Rationale. Held by Brethren; opposed both to perfectionism (claiming sinless attainment) and antinomian quietism. Mortify-and-vivify is the apostolic pattern.

Scripture: Romans 6:11-14, Romans 8:13, 2 Corinthians 3:18, Philippians 2:12-13, 1 Thessalonians 4:3, Hebrews 12:14, Colossians 3:5-10 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 13, Heidelberg Catechism Q86-Q90

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Some Brethren historically engaged Keswick / 'higher life' models; classical progressive view is sturdier.

doc-regeneration-monergistic

Soteriology › Regeneration

CONVICTIONAL

Regeneration (the new birth) is a monergistic work of the Holy Spirit, sovereignly imparting spiritual life to those dead in sin; logically prior to and the cause of saving faith.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 7/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox

Rationale. John 3 / John 6 / Ezekiel 36 / Eph 2 require God-initiated new birth; even most Arminian Brethren grant prevenient grace must precede genuine response.

Scripture: John 3:3-8, John 6:63-65, Ezekiel 36:26-27, Ephesians 2:4-5, Titus 3:5, 1 Peter 1:3 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 10, Canons of Dort 3/4.11-12

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Distinct from decisional-regeneration (which inverts the order) — see doc-decisional-regeneration.

doc-semi-pelagianism-denial

Soteriology › Denied Errors

CONVICTIONAL

Semi-Pelagianism — the teaching that the sinner takes the first step toward God by natural ability, with grace then assisting — is a denied error.

Position: DENY · **Martyrdom:** 7/10 · **Consensus:** heretical

Rationale. Condemned at Second Council of Orange (529); inverts the order of grace; in practice describes a great deal of folk-evangelical altar-call theology.

Scripture: John 6:44, John 6:65, Romans 9:16, Philippians 2:13, Ephesians 2:8-9 | **Confessions:** Second Council of Orange 529, Canons of Dort 3/4

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Many otherwise-evangelical churches drift into functional semi-Pelagianism without realizing it; useful diagnostic for evaluating church soundness.

Ecclesiology

doc-christ-alone-head-of-church

Ecclesiology › Nature of the Church

ESSENTIAL

Christ alone is the Head of the Church; no human being holds that office or shares that authority.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 10/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox · **Cult marker** · **Evangelism target if denied**

Rationale. Scripture is unambiguous: Christ is sole Head. Any human claiming to be vicar, prophet, or sole conduit of revelation usurps Christ's office — this is the classic cult-leader pattern.

Scripture: Ephesians 1:22-23, Ephesians 5:23, Colossians 1:18, Colossians 2:19 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 25.6, Belgic Confession 31, Second Helvetic Confession 17

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

The one cult-marker in this slot. If a group exalts a human leader to a position only Christ holds (sole revelator, ultimate authority over conscience, vicar of Christ on earth in the strong sense), treat as cult-grade aberration.

doc-church-body-of-christ

Ecclesiology › Nature of the Church

ESSENTIAL

The Church is the body of Christ, a spiritual organism composed of all true believers from Pentecost to the rapture, united to Christ by the indwelling Holy Spirit.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 9/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox

Rationale. Pauline ecclesiology presents the Church as Christ's body and bride, not a human institution. Brethren tradition strongly emphasizes the spiritual, organic nature of the Church over institutional forms.

Scripture: 1 Corinthians 12:12-27, Ephesians 1:22-23, Ephesians 4:4-6, Ephesians 5:25-32, Colossians 1:18, Romans 12:4-5 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 25.1, Belgic Confession 27, Nicene Creed (one holy catholic apostolic Church)

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Foundational ecclesiology. Denial typically signals serious doctrinal aberration (cult, deeply unorthodox group).

doc-autonomy-of-local-assembly

Ecclesiology › Nature of the Church

CONVICTIONAL

Each local assembly is autonomous under Christ's headship, governed by its own elders, not subordinate to a denominational hierarchy or external bishop.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 6/10 · Consensus: divided · Brethren distinctive

Rationale. Brethren and broader free-church distinctive. NT churches are seen consulting one another (Acts 15) but not subjected to a hierarchy.

Scripture: Acts 14:23, Titus 1:5, Acts 20:17-28, 1 Peter 5:1-4, Revelation 2-3 | Confessions: 1689 Baptist Confession 26.7-26.8, Cambridge Platform (congregationalist)

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	-	Break fellow.	-

Episcopal and presbyterian polities are widely held by orthodox Christians. User's tradition affirms congregational/independent polity. Membership commitment is for autonomous-assembly churches; visiting episcopal/presbyterian churches is fine.

doc-marks-of-true-church

Ecclesiology › Nature of the Church

CONVICTIONAL

A true visible church is marked by: (1) the Word of God rightly preached, (2) the ordinances rightly administered, (3) church discipline rightly exercised.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 7/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. These three Reformation marks are the classic Protestant test for church validity. A gathering missing all three is not a true church regardless of name.

Scripture: Acts 2:42, Matthew 28:19-20, Matthew 18:15-20, 1 Timothy 3:15, Titus 1:5 | Confessions: Belgic Confession 29, Scots Confession 18, Westminster Confession 25.4

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Practical evaluation grid for London church search. A group with strong programs but no expository preaching, careless ordinances, or zero discipline fails the marks test.

doc-no-clergy-laity-distinction

Ecclesiology › Nature of the Church

CONVICTIONAL

Scripture knows no two-tier clergy/laity distinction; all believers are saints and ministers, with elders functioning as servant-overseers, not a priestly class.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 6/10 · Consensus: minority · Brethren distinctive

Rationale. Brethren distinctive flowing from priesthood-of-all-believers. NT terminology for ministers (servants, overseers, shepherds) is functional, not sacerdotal. The clergy/laity wall is a post-apostolic development.

Scripture: 1 Peter 2:9, Matthew 23:8-12, 1 Corinthians 12:4-31, Ephesians 4:11-12, 1 Peter 5:1-4 | Confessions: Brethren tradition (no formal confession; embodied in assembly practice)

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	-	Break fellow.	-

User position formed in Brethren tradition. Visiting and participating in clergy-led churches is fine for evaluation, but membership requires alignment on plurality and lay-ministry principles. Most evangelical churches have a soft clergy/laity practice without strong sacerdotal claims.

doc-one-holy-catholic-apostolic-church

Ecclesiology › Nature of the Church

CONVICTIONAL

The Church is one (united in Christ), holy (set apart, indwelt by the Spirit), catholic (universal across time and place), and apostolic (built on the apostles' teaching, not on apostolic succession of office).

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 7/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Affirm the Nicene marks understood Protestantly: apostolic = continuity with apostolic doctrine, not unbroken episcopal succession.

Scripture: Ephesians 2:19-22, Ephesians 4:3-6, Acts 2:42, Jude 3 | Confessions: Nicene Creed, Apostles' Creed, Westminster Confession 25

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Affirm the Nicene marks; reject Roman/Orthodox interpretation of 'apostolic' as unbroken episcopal succession. Doctrinal continuity, not institutional pedigree, is the real apostolicity.

doc-priesthood-of-all-believers

Ecclesiology › Nature of the Church

CONVICTIONAL

Every believer is a priest before God through Christ; there is no mediatorial priesthood between Christ and the believer beyond Christ Himself.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 7/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Reformation principle, strongly held in Brethren tradition. Direct access to God through Christ alone; no sacerdotal class is needed to mediate grace.

Scripture: 1 Peter 2:5, 1 Peter 2:9, Revelation 1:6, Revelation 5:10, Hebrews 4:14-16, Hebrews 10:19-22, 1 Timothy 2:5 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 8.1, Heidelberg Catechism Q31, 1689 Baptist Confession 26.4

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Rome and Eastern Orthodoxy hold a sacerdotal priesthood; this is a confessional Protestant divide. Brethren tradition is the strongest expression of this principle (no clergy/laity).

Sacraments

doc-baptismal-regeneration-denial

Sacraments › Baptism

CONVICTIONAL

Baptism does not regenerate, save, or wash away sin in itself (ex opere operato); it is the outward sign of an inward reality already accomplished by grace through faith.

Position: DENY · **Martyrdom:** 7/10 · **Consensus:** divided

Rationale. Salvation is by grace through faith alone (Eph 2:8-9). Sacraments are signs and seals, not the cause of grace. Treating water as the saving instrument confuses sign and thing-signified.

Scripture: Ephesians 2:8-9, Romans 4:9-12, 1 Peter 3:21, Luke 23:43, Acts 10:44-48 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 28.5, Belgic Confession 34, 1689 Baptist Confession 29

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Heterodox-bordering-heretical when held strongly (Rome, some Lutheran formulations, Church of Christ). Treating baptism as the saving instrument compromises sola fide. Distinct from sacramental realism (Lutheran 'effectual sign').

doc-memorial-view-lords-supper

Sacraments › Lord's Supper

CONVICTIONAL

The Lord's Supper is primarily a memorial of Christ's once-for-all atoning death, accompanied by spiritual communion with the risen Christ by faith. It is not a re-sacrifice and the elements do not change in substance.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 6/10 · **Consensus:** divided

Rationale. 'Do this in remembrance of me' (Luke 22:19; 1 Cor 11:24-26). Brethren tradition holds a memorial view with strong spiritual presence overtones — feeding on Christ by faith, not on transformed elements.

Scripture: Luke 22:19, 1 Corinthians 11:23-26, 1 Corinthians 10:16-17, John 6:63, Hebrews 10:10-14 | **Confessions:** 1689 Baptist Confession 30, Belgic Confession 35, Westminster Confession 29

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	-

User position is memorial + spiritual presence (Calvinist-Brethren synthesis). Lutheran consubstantiation and Calvin's spiritual-feeding view are within tolerable orthodoxy. Roman transubstantiation is rejected.

doc-paedobaptism-denial

Sacraments › Baptism

CONVICTIONAL

Infant baptism (paedobaptism) lacks New Testament warrant; the covenant-of-grace argument from circumcision is theologically inadequate to override the consistent NT pattern of faith preceding baptism.

Position: DENY · Martyrdom: 5/10 · Consensus: divided · Brethren distinctive

Rationale. Every recorded NT baptism follows profession of faith. Paedobaptism is inferred from covenant theology, not commanded. Brethren and Baptist traditions reject it.

Scripture: Acts 2:41, Acts 8:12, Acts 18:8, Mark 16:16, Acts 2:38 | **Confessions:** 1689 Baptist Confession 29.2, Brethren tradition

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	-	Break fellow.	-

Massive orthodox tradition holds paedobaptism (Reformed, Anglican, Lutheran, Presbyterian, Methodist, Rome, Eastern Orthodoxy). User denies but recognises paedobaptists as fellow Christians. Not break-fellowship; is membership-deciding.

doc-transubstantiation-denial

Sacraments › Lord's Supper

CONVICTIONAL

Transubstantiation — the Roman doctrine that the substance of the bread and wine is changed into the substance of Christ's body and blood while only the accidents remain — is unbiblical and philosophically untenable.

Position: DENY · Martyrdom: 7/10 · Consensus: divided

Rationale. Christ's bodily ascension means his physical body is at the Father's right hand. The Mass as ongoing propitiatory sacrifice undermines Hebrews' once-for-all completed atonement. The Aristotelian substance/accident framework is imposed on Scripture.

Scripture: Hebrews 7:27, Hebrews 9:12, Hebrews 10:10-14, Acts 1:9-11, John 6:63 | **Confessions:** Thirty-Nine Articles 28, Belgic Confession 35, Westminster Confession 29.6, 1689 Baptist Confession 30.6

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	-

Reformers were martyred over this. The Mass-as-sacrifice is gospel-adjacent and serious. Reject definitively but classify Rome as heterodox Christianity, not cult.

doc-two-ordinances

Sacraments › Number and Nature

CONVICTIONAL

Christ instituted two ordinances for the Church: baptism and the Lord's Supper. They are signs and seals, not means of saving grace ex opere operato.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 5/10 · Consensus: divided

Rationale. Only baptism and the Supper are explicitly commanded by Christ for ongoing church practice. Brethren prefer 'ordinance' (commanded) over 'sacrament' (mystery) to underline non-mystical nature.

Scripture: Matthew 28:19, Luke 22:19-20, 1 Corinthians 11:23-26 | Confessions: 1689 Baptist Confession 28.1, Westminster Confession 27.4

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	-

Rome and Eastern Orthodoxy hold seven sacraments; Protestants generally hold two. Brethren use 'ordinance' to distance from Roman sacramentology.

prc-believers-baptism-by-immersion

Sacraments › Baptism

CONVICTIONAL

Baptism is for professing believers only, administered by full immersion as a public confession of faith and identification with Christ's death, burial, and resurrection.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 6/10 · Consensus: divided · Brethren distinctive

Rationale. NT pattern is consistent: faith precedes baptism. The mode (immersion) symbolises burial and resurrection (Rom 6). Brethren distinctive that aligns with broader Baptist tradition.

Scripture: Acts 2:38, Acts 8:36-38, Acts 16:31-33, Romans 6:3-4, Colossians 2:12, Matthew 28:19, Mark 16:16 | Confessions: 1689 Baptist Confession 29, Brethren tradition

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	-	Break fellow.	-

Membership-deciding for user. Will visit/participate at paedobaptist churches (Reformed, Anglican, Lutheran) but cannot formally join a church that requires endorsement of infant baptism. Reasonable disagreement among orthodox Christians; not break-fellowship-level.

Leadership & Polity

CONVICTIONAL

Held by Rome, Eastern Orthodoxy, high-church Anglicans. Heterodox-not-cult. Rome is a heterodox-Christian tradition with serious gospel concerns, not a cult. Affirming successionists who hold orthodox christology and trinitarianism are still in the Christian family broadly understood.

CONVICTIONAL

Anglican, Roman, Eastern Orthodox, Methodist hold episcopal polity. Many godly believers and orthodox doctrine within these traditions. User holds congregational/independent view; visiting Anglican worship fine.

doc-papal-supremacy-denial

Leadership & Polity › Ordination

CONVICTIONAL

Papal supremacy and infallibility — the Bishop of Rome as head of the universal Church and infallible in faith and morals when speaking ex cathedra — has no biblical or early-church warrant.

Position: DENY · **Martyrdom:** 6/10 · **Consensus:** divided

Rationale. Christ alone is Head of the Church (Eph 1:22). Peter received no transferable primacy; the rock of Matt 16 is Peter's confession, not his office. Papal infallibility (1870) is a recent dogma without ancient consensus.

Scripture: Ephesians 1:22-23, Matthew 16:18, Matthew 23:8-10, 1 Peter 5:1 (Peter calling himself fellow-elder), Galatians 2:11-14 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 25.6, Thirty-Nine Articles 37, Belgic Confession 31

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	-

Reformers were martyred over this. The Pope is a man, not Christ's vicar in the strong sense. Distinct from cult-leader claims because the office, not a single individual, is exalted; still a serious aberration. Rome remains Christian-heterodox, not cult.

doc-plurality-of-elders

Leadership & Polity › Eldership

CONVICTIONAL

Each local assembly should be led by a plurality of qualified elders (overseers/shepherds), not a single senior pastor; elders rule and shepherd jointly.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 5/10 · **Consensus:** divided · **Brethren distinctive**

Rationale. NT consistently uses plural elders for each local church (Acts 14:23; 20:17; Titus 1:5; Phil 1:1). Brethren distinctive that protects against autocracy and lone-pastor burnout. Strong scriptural pattern.

Scripture: Acts 14:23, Acts 20:17, Acts 20:28, Titus 1:5, Philipians 1:1, 1 Timothy 5:17, 1 Peter 5:1-4, James 5:14 | **Confessions:** Brethren tradition, Reformed plurality view (e.g., 1689 Baptist Confession 26.8)

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	-	Break fellow.	-

Membership-deciding for user. Many sound evangelical churches operate on senior-pastor model — visit and participate fine. Formal membership requires plurality of elders. London search: prioritise plural-elder churches.

doc-single-pastor-model-denial

Leadership & Polity › Eldership

CONVICTIONAL

The single-pastor / senior-pastor-as-CEO model lacks NT warrant; concentrating authority and teaching ministry in one man departs from the apostolic plurality pattern and tends toward personality-driven dysfunction.

Position: DENY · Martyrdom: 4/10 · Consensus: divided · Brethren distinctive

Rationale. Concentration of authority creates accountability gaps, celebrity-pastor culture, and church-splits when the man falls. Plurality is biblical and prudential.

Scripture: Acts 14:23, Titus 1:5, 1 Peter 5:1-4, Hebrews 13:17 | Confessions: Brethren tradition

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	-	Break fellow.	-

Most evangelical churches in London are senior-pastor model. User can visit/participate; membership requires functional plurality. Watch for: real plurality vs. nominal elder boards rubber-stamping a CEO-pastor.

doc-women-elders-pastors-denial

Leadership & Polity › Office and Gender

CONVICTIONAL

The office of elder/overseer is reserved for qualified men; women are not to hold the eldership/teaching-pastor office over mixed adult assemblies.

Position: DENY · Martyrdom: 4/10 · Consensus: divided

Rationale. 1 Tim 2:11-15 and 1 Tim 3:1-7 (qualifications include 'husband of one wife') establish male eldership. Brethren tradition consistently complementarian.

Scripture: 1 Timothy 2:11-15, 1 Timothy 3:1-7, Titus 1:5-9, 1 Corinthians 14:33-35 | Confessions: Brethren tradition, Confessional Reformed and Baptist tradition, Danvers Statement

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	-	Break fellow.	-

Egalitarian view is widely held by orthodox Christians today, particularly in mainline and many evangelical churches. User holds complementarian view firmly but recognises sincere disagreement. Membership-deciding; fellowship/visiting fine. Distinguish from full-blown ordination of women bishops in liberal traditions tied to broader gospel issues.

prc-women-teaching-mixed-adult-assemblies-denial

Leadership & Polity › Office and Gender

CONVICTIONAL

Women should not exercise authoritative teaching ministry over mixed adult assemblies in the gathered church (sermon, doctrinal instruction); women teaching women, children, or in informal contexts is not in view.

Position: DENY · Martyrdom: 3/10 · Consensus: divided · Brethren distinctive

Rationale. 1 Tim 2:12 specifically restricts authoritative teaching over men in the gathered assembly. Titus 2 commands women to teach women. The complementary pattern affirms women's gifting in non-authoritative contexts.

Scripture: 1 Timothy 2:11-15, Titus 2:3-5, 1 Corinthians 14:33-35, Acts 18:26 | **Confessions:** Brethren tradition, Danvers Statement

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	-	Break fellow.	-

Complementarian distinction. Priscilla teaching Apollos (privately, with husband) is the model for informal exhortation. Women preaching from the pulpit to mixed adults is not user's practice; visiting such churches fine but membership unlikely.

Church Discipline

prc-church-discipline

Church Discipline › Discipline Process

CONVICTIONAL

Church discipline follows the Matthew 18 progression — private confrontation, small-group confrontation, assembly confrontation, removal — and is exercised in love for repentance and restoration.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 5/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Direct dominical command. A church that never disciplines lacks one of the three Reformation marks. Discipline preserves the assembly's purity and witness, and aims at sinner's restoration.

Scripture: Matthew 18:15-20, 1 Corinthians 5:1-13, 2 Thessalonians 3:6-15, Galatians 6:1, Titus 3:10-11 | **Confessions:** Belgic Confession 32, Westminster Confession 30, 1689 Baptist Confession 26.7

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	-

Watch for both extremes: (a) churches that never discipline (false love) and (b) churches that discipline harshly without restoration aim (legalism). Both are dysfunction. The user's tradition has had both forms — discernment required.

CONVICTIONAL

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	-	Break fellow.	-

CONVICTIONAL

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	-

Tier: ESSENTIAL CONVICTIONAL IMPORTANT PREFERENCE SPIRITUAL MATURITY

V = Visit · P = Participate · S = Serve in ministry · Mb = Become member (if a church teaches the opposite) Cult = denial flags cult-grade error Brt = Brethren distinctive

prc-women-silence-in-mixed-assembly

Worship Structure › Order in Assembly

CONVICTIONAL

Women are not to take up authoritative speaking ministry (sermon, doctrinal teaching, leading the assembly) in the gathered mixed assembly (1 Cor 14:34-35; 1 Tim 2:11-12); women may pray, sing, prophesy in non-authoritative contexts, share testimony, and minister widely otherwise.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 3/10 · **Consensus:** divided · **Brethren** distinctive

Rationale. Pauline command tied to creation order, not just culture (1 Tim 2:13-14 grounds it pre-fall). Brethren tradition consistently observes this. Distinct from heavy-handed silencing; women sing, pray, etc. — the restriction is on authoritative speaking that exercises office.

Scripture: 1 Corinthians 14:33-35, 1 Timothy 2:11-15, 1 Corinthians 11:5 | **Confessions:** Brethren tradition, Danvers Statement

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	-	Break fellow.	-

Note exegetical tension: 1 Cor 11:5 mentions women praying/prophesying; 1 Cor 14:34 commands silence. Best harmonisation: 1 Cor 14 restricts authoritative judging of prophecy and disruptive question-asking, not all speaking. User's complementarian position is membership-relevant; visiting egalitarian churches fine.

doc-ecumenism-with-non-trinitarian-groups-denial

Inter-church Relations › Ecumenism

ESSENTIAL

Ecumenical or fellowship union with non-Trinitarian groups (Mormonism, Jehovah's Witnesses, Oneness Pentecostalism, Unitarianism) is rejected; these groups are not Christian in the historical-creedal sense and require evangelism, not partnership.

Position: DENY · **Martyrdom:** 9/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox

Rationale. Trinity is the boundary of the Christian faith (Athanasian Creed). Fellowship with groups denying it would compromise the gospel. They are evangelism targets.

Scripture: Matthew 28:19, John 1:1-18, John 5:23, 1 John 2:22-23, 2 John 9-11 | **Confessions:** Nicene Creed, Athanasian Creed, all Reformed confessions

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Mormons, JW, Oneness etc. — these are evangelism targets. Trinity is non-negotiable. Cross-listed with theology-proper slot; here flagged for ecclesial-relations purposes.

doc-ecumenism-with-rome-denial

Inter-church Relations › Ecumenism

CONVICTIONAL

Formal ecumenical union with the Roman Catholic Church on shared sacramental, ministerial, and gospel ground is rejected so long as Rome maintains its post-Tridentine positions on justification, the Mass as sacrifice, papal infallibility, and Marian dogmas.

Position: DENY · Martyrdom: 6/10 · Consensus: divided

Rationale. Rome's Council of Trent anathematised the Reformation gospel and has not retracted it. ECT-style co-belligerence on social issues is not the same as gospel union. Affirm friendship and dialogue with Roman Catholic individuals; deny ecclesial union.

Scripture: Galatians 1:6-9, 2 Corinthians 6:14-18, 2 John 9-11 | Confessions: Westminster Confession 25.6, Belgic Confession 29

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	-

Distinguish (a) personal love and engagement with Roman Catholics — affirmed — from (b) institutional ecumenical union — denied. Roman Catholic individuals may be true believers despite the institution's errors; the gospel pierces every system.

Eschatology

doc-bodily-resurrection-all

Eschatology › Resurrection

ESSENTIAL

There will be a bodily resurrection of both the just and the unjust at the end of the age.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 10/10 · Consensus: orthodox · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. Daniel 12:2, John 5:28-29, and Acts 24:15 are explicit: all the dead will rise — believers to life, unbelievers to judgment. The resurrection body is physical, glorified for believers (1 Cor 15).

Scripture: John 5:28-29, Acts 24:15, Daniel 12:2, 1 Corinthians 15:42-49, Philippians 3:21, Revelation 20:12-13 | Confessions: Apostles' Creed, Nicene Creed, Westminster Confession 32

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

doc-eternal-conscious-torment

Eschatology › Hell

ESSENTIAL

Unbelievers face eternal, conscious punishment in hell as the just judgment of a holy God.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale.

Christ's own words (Matt 25:46) parallel eternal punishment with eternal life — the same Greek word. Revelation describes torment 'forever and ever' (Rev 14:11, 20:10). This is the historic, orthodox, confessional position.

Scripture:

Matthew 25:46, Revelation 14:9-11, Revelation 20:10, Mark 9:43-48, 2 Thessalonians 1:9, Jude 1:7

Confessions:

Westminster Confession 33, Athanasian Creed, Brethren tradition

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Denied by Jehovah's Witnesses (annihilationism), Seventh-day Adventists (conditional immortality), and increasingly by some evangelicals (e.g., John Stott considered annihilationism).

doc-final-judgment

Eschatology › Judgment

ESSENTIAL

Christ will judge all people at his return — believers to eternal life, unbelievers to eternal punishment.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 10/10 · Consensus: orthodox · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale.

Scripture is unambiguous about a final judgment of all people, with eternal consequences (Matt 25:31-46, Rev 20:11-15). The reality of judgment grounds the urgency of the gospel.

Scripture:

Matthew 25:31-46, Revelation 20:11-15, 2 Corinthians 5:10, Acts 17:31, Hebrews 9:27, Romans 2:5-11

Confessions:

Apostles' Creed, Westminster Confession 33, Brethren tradition

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

doc-full-preterism-denial

Eschatology › Preterism

ESSENTIAL

Full preterism — all prophecy including the second coming was fulfilled in AD 70 — is rejected as a denial of the bodily return of Christ.

Position: DENY · Martyrdom: 7/10 · Consensus: heretical · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale.

Full preterism denies the future bodily return of Christ, the future bodily resurrection, and the future final judgment. This crosses from in-house disagreement into heresy. Partial preterism (some prophecy fulfilled in AD 70, but a future second coming) is orthodox.

Scripture:

Acts 1:11, 1 Corinthians 15:23-28, 1 Thessalonians 4:16-17, Revelation 20:11-15

Confessions:

all historic creeds and confessions

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Distinguish from partial preterism (R.C. Sproul, Gentry) which is orthodox. Full preterism (hyper-preterism) collapses Christian hope.

doc-second-coming-bodily

Eschatology › Return of Christ

ESSENTIAL

Jesus Christ will return personally, visibly, audibly, and bodily to judge the living and the dead.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 10/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox · **Evangelism target if denied**

Rationale. The angels at the ascension declared Christ would return in the same manner he was taken up (Acts 1:11). Every eye will see him (Rev 1:7). This is a non-negotiable apostolic and creedal hope.

Scripture: Acts 1:11, Matthew 24:30, 1 Thessalonians 4:16, Revelation 1:7, 2 Thessalonians 1:7-10, Titus 2:13 | **Confessions:** Apostles' Creed, Nicene Creed, Westminster Confession 33, Brethren tradition (premillennial expectation)

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Spiritualized return (already happened invisibly in 1914, etc.) is taught by Jehovah's Witnesses and full preterists; both deviate from apostolic teaching.

doc-universalism-denial

Eschatology › Hell

ESSENTIAL

Universalism — the view that all people will ultimately be saved — is rejected as contrary to Scripture and historic Christianity.

Position: DENY · **Martyrdom:** 8/10 · **Consensus:** heretical · **Evangelism target if denied**

Rationale. Christ explicitly speaks of those who go to eternal punishment (Matt 25:46), of a narrow gate few find (Matt 7:13-14), and of the unforgivable sin (Matt 12:31-32). Universalism collapses the urgency of the gospel and was condemned in connection with Origenism at Constantinople II (553).

Scripture: Matthew 25:46, Matthew 7:13-14, John 3:36, 2 Thessalonians 1:9, Revelation 21:8 | **Confessions:** Second Council of Constantinople (553), Westminster Confession 33, Reformed and Brethren tradition

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Includes hopeful universalism (Bell, Hart) and dogmatic universalism (Unitarian Universalism, Christian Universalists). Removes the necessity of conscious faith in Christ.

doc-annihilationism-denial

Eschatology › Hell

CONVICTIONAL

Annihilationism (the view that the wicked are ultimately destroyed and cease to exist) is rejected as inconsistent with biblical teaching on eternal punishment.

Position: DENY · **Martyrdom:** 5/10 · **Consensus:** minority

Rationale. Matt 25:46's grammatical parallelism between eternal life and eternal punishment requires both to be of the same duration. While some orthodox figures (Stott, Wenham, Fudge) have held conditionalism, the historic and confessional position is eternal conscious torment.

Scripture: Matthew 25:46, Revelation 14:11, Revelation 20:10, Daniel 12:2, Mark 9:48 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 33, historic Reformed and Brethren tradition

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	-

Held by some genuinely orthodox evangelicals (Stott, Pinnock, Fudge); however, when paired with Adventism or JW it is part of a wider heterodox or cultic system. Distinguish the doctrine from the holders.

doc-imminence-no-date-setting

Eschatology › Return of Christ

CONVICTIONAL

Christ's return is imminent and could occur at any time, but no one knows the day or the hour, and date-setting is forbidden.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 4/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox

Rationale. Christ explicitly says 'no one knows the day or hour, not even the Son' (Matt 24:36). Date-setters (Miller 1844, Camping 2011, JW dates) all fail and bring reproach. Watchfulness, not calculation, is the posture.

Scripture: Matthew 24:36, Matthew 24:42-44, Acts 1:7, 1 Thessalonians 5:1-2, Mark 13:32-33 | **Confessions:** historic Christian consensus, Brethren tradition

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Date-setting movements are typically cult-adjacent (Millerism, Watch Tower 1914/1925/1975, Camping).

doc-intermediate-state

Eschatology › Intermediate State

CONVICTIONAL

Believers who die are immediately present with the Lord, conscious and at rest, awaiting the resurrection of the body.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 5/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox

Rationale. Paul says to depart is to be with Christ (Phil 1:23) and to be absent from the body is to be at home with the Lord (2 Cor 5:8). The thief is told 'today you will be with me in paradise' (Luke 23:43).

Scripture: Philippians 1:23, 2 Corinthians 5:6-8, Luke 23:43, Revelation 6:9-11, Luke 16:22 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 32, Brethren tradition

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	-

doc-new-heavens-new-earth

Eschatology › Final State

CONVICTIONAL

God will create new heavens and a new earth in which righteousness dwells, the eternal home of the redeemed.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 7/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox

Rationale. The hope of believers is not a disembodied heaven but a renewed cosmos (Isa 65, 2 Pet 3, Rev 21). Creation itself will be liberated from corruption (Rom 8).

Scripture: Isaiah 65:17, 2 Peter 3:13, Revelation 21:1-5, Romans 8:19-23, Isaiah 66:22 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 33, Brethren tradition

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	-

A purely spiritual / non-material final state misreads biblical hope; resurrection bodies require a renewed creation.

doc-purgatory-denial

Eschatology › Intermediate State

CONVICTIONAL

Purgatory — a post-mortem place of purification for believers — is rejected as having no biblical basis.

Position: DENY · **Martyrdom:** 6/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox

Rationale. Christ's atonement is fully sufficient (Heb 10:14). To be absent from the body is to be present with the Lord (2 Cor 5:8), not in a purifying fire. The doctrine is built on apocryphal texts (2 Maccabees) and tradition, not Scripture.

Scripture: Hebrews 10:14, 2 Corinthians 5:8, Luke 23:43, 1 John 1:7, Romans 8:1 | **Confessions:** Thirty-Nine Articles 22, Westminster Confession 32, Brethren tradition

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Held by Roman Catholicism. Reformation-era articles explicitly reject it as 'a fond thing vainly invented.'

Angelology

doc-angels-exist

Angelology › Existence

CONVICTIONAL

Angels exist as personal, created, ministering spirits who serve God and his elect.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 4/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox

Rationale. Scripture from Genesis to Revelation is replete with angelic beings. Hebrews 1:14 calls them 'ministering spirits sent out to serve those who will inherit salvation.' The categories (cherubim, seraphim, archangels) are biblical.

Scripture: Hebrews 1:14, Psalm 103:20-21, Isaiah 6:1-3, Daniel 10:13, Luke 1:19, Jude 1:9 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 4, historic Christian consensus

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Sadducees denied angels (Acts 23:8); some liberal theology demythologizes them.

doc-fallen-angels

Angelology › Fallen Angels

CONVICTIONAL

A portion of the angels fell into rebellion under Satan and are now demons opposed to God.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 5/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox

Rationale. 2 Pet 2:4, Jude 6, and Rev 12:9 describe angelic rebellion. Demons are repeatedly cast out by Christ. Their existence and opposition are a non-negotiable backdrop of NT ministry.

Scripture: 2 Peter 2:4, Jude 1:6, Revelation 12:7-9, Matthew 25:41, Ephesians 6:12 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 4, historic Christian consensus

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Demonology

doc-satan-personal-being

Demonology › Satan

CONVICTIONAL

Satan is a real, personal, created spiritual being who opposes God and his people.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 6/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox

Rationale. Christ personally addresses Satan (Matt 4), Job 1-2 portrays him as a real adversary, and 1 Pet 5:8 calls believers to resist him. Reducing Satan to a metaphor for evil contradicts Christ's own treatment of him.

Scripture: Matthew 4:1-11, Job 1:6-12, 1 Peter 5:8, Revelation 12:9, John 8:44, Genesis 3:1-5 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 4, all historic creeds

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Christadelphians and some liberal traditions reduce Satan to a personification of human evil; this is heterodox.

Cult Marker

cult-branhamism

Cult Marker › Branhamism

ESSENTIAL

No 20th-century individual (William Branham) is the foretold end-time prophet or 'Elijah'; the canon is closed and no human revelation supplements Scripture.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 10/10 · Consensus: orthodox · **Cult marker** · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. Branham claimed to be the prophet of the 'seventh angel' of Rev 10, taught the 'Serpent Seed' doctrine, denied the Trinity, and made false prophecies. Multiple cult-grade errors plus authoritarian elevation of a single man.

Scripture: Jude 1:3, Galatians 1:8-9, Deuteronomy 18:21-22, Matthew 24:23-26 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 1, Nicene Creed

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Branhamism / William Branham / 'Message' churches — Branham as end-time prophet, Serpent Seed (Eve's sin was sexual), Oneness Pentecostal, predestination distortions. Cult.

cult-children-of-god

Cult Marker › Family International

ESSENTIAL

Christian sexual ethics and the protection of children are non-negotiable; movements practicing 'flirty fishing' or sexualizing evangelism or children are cults.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 10/10 · Consensus: orthodox · **Cult marker** · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. Children of God / Family International (David Berg) practiced 'flirty fishing' (sexual evangelism), sexual abuse of minors documented, and Berg's 'Mo Letters' as ongoing revelation. Combines doctrinal heresy with predatory sexual abuse. Definitive cult.

Scripture: Matthew 18:6, 1 Thessalonians 4:3-7, 1 Corinthians 6:9-10, Hebrews 13:4 | **Confessions:** Westminster Larger Catechism on the Seventh Commandment

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Children of God / The Family / Family International (David Berg) — sexual abuse, 'flirty fishing,' Mo Letters as ongoing revelation. Criminal cult.

cult-christian-science-physical-reality

Cult Marker › Christian Science

ESSENTIAL

Sin, sickness, suffering, and physical reality are real; salvation is from real sin to real eternal life through Christ's real death and resurrection.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 10/10 · Consensus: orthodox · Cult marker · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. Genesis 1 affirms creation as good and material. Christ took on real flesh (John 1:14) and bore real sin (1 Pet 2:24). Christian Science's denial of physical reality, sin, and the need for salvation is a Gnostic-style heresy that empties the gospel.

Scripture: John 1:14, 1 Peter 2:24, Genesis 1:31, 1 John 4:2-3, Romans 3:23, Romans 6:23 | **Confessions:** Nicene Creed, Chalcedonian Definition, all historic confessions

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Denied by Christian Science (Mary Baker Eddy): sin, sickness, and matter are illusions. Refusal of medical care has caused deaths. A definitive cult.

cult-icc-baptismal-regeneration

Cult Marker › International Churches of Christ

ESSENTIAL

Salvation is by grace alone through faith alone in Christ alone; baptism is an outward sign of inward faith, not the instrument of regeneration; and 'discipling' must not become spiritual abuse.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: orthodox · Cult marker · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. Eph 2:8-9 — by grace, through faith, not of works. The thief on the cross was saved without baptism. ICC adds baptism as necessary for salvation AND requires submission to a 'discipler' for every life decision — combining works-salvation with cultic control.

Scripture: Ephesians 2:8-9, Luke 23:43, Romans 4:5, Galatians 2:16, Acts 10:44-48 | **Confessions:** all Reformation confessions on sola fide

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

International Churches of Christ (ICC, Boston Movement, Kip McKean) — baptismal regeneration plus authoritarian discipling. Classified as a cult by virtually all countercult ministries. Distinguish from mainline Churches of Christ (Restoration Movement) which, while holding baptismal regeneration, lack the cult dynamics.

cult-iglesia-ni-cristo

Cult Marker › Iglesia ni Cristo

ESSENTIAL

Jesus Christ is fully God and the only mediator between God and man; no human founder of a 20th-century church (Felix Manalo) is God's last messenger.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 10/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox · **Cult marker** · **Evangelism target if denied**

Rationale. INC denies the Trinity, denies Christ's deity, and elevates Felix Manalo as the foretold 'angel from the east' and final messenger. This combines Arianism with extra-biblical revelation. The faith was once for all delivered (Jude 3).

Scripture: 1 Timothy 2:5, John 1:1, Jude 1:3, Galatians 1:8-9, John 14:6 | **Confessions:** Nicene Creed, all historic creeds

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Iglesia ni Cristo (Philippines, Felix Manalo, 1914) — denies Trinity, denies Christ's deity, claims Manalo as God's last messenger. Cult-grade. Also block-voting and authoritarian governance.

cult-jw-bodily-resurrection-of-christ

Cult Marker › Jehovah's Witnesses

ESSENTIAL

Jesus Christ rose bodily from the dead in the same physical body that was crucified, now glorified.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 10/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox · **Cult marker** · **Evangelism target if denied**

Rationale. Christ shows his disciples his hands and side (John 20:27), eats fish (Luke 24:42-43), and explicitly says 'a spirit does not have flesh and bones as you see I have' (Luke 24:39). The resurrection of the same body is the cornerstone of the gospel (1 Cor 15).

Scripture: Luke 24:39-43, John 20:27, 1 Corinthians 15:3-8, John 2:19-21, Acts 2:31 | **Confessions:** Apostles' Creed, Nicene Creed, all historic confessions

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Denied by Jehovah's Witnesses (Christ raised as a spirit creature, not in his body). Also denied by Christian Science (no physical resurrection) and various liberal/progressive groups.

cult-jw-christ-deity-denial

Cult Marker › Jehovah's Witnesses

ESSENTIAL

Jesus Christ is fully and uniquely God, eternally begotten and not created, equal in essence with the Father.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 10/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox · **Cult marker** · **Evangelism target if denied**

Rationale. John 1:1, John 8:58, John 20:28, Col 2:9, Heb 1:8 — Christ is unambiguously God. The Arian view (Christ as a created being or 'a god') was condemned at Nicaea (325). The NWT's 'a god' in John 1:1 is a tendentious mistranslation.

Scripture: John 1:1, John 8:58, John 20:28, Colossians 2:9, Hebrews 1:8, Philippians 2:6 | **Confessions:** Nicene Creed (325/381), Athanasian Creed, all historic creeds and confessions

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Denied by Jehovah's Witnesses (Watch Tower) — Christ as Michael the archangel, a created being. Also denied by Christadelphians, Iglesia ni Cristo, The Way International, and Unitarians.

cult-mormon-continuing-prophecy

Cult Marker › Mormonism

ESSENTIAL

Scripture (the 66-book canon) is closed and sufficient; no later 'scripture' (Book of Mormon, Doctrine and Covenants, Pearl of Great Price) can claim equal authority.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 10/10 · Consensus: orthodox · **Cult marker** · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. Jude 3 — 'the faith once for all delivered to the saints.' Rev 22:18 forbids adding to the prophecy. Gal 1:8 — even an angel preaching another gospel is to be accursed. Joseph Smith's claimed revelations contradict and supplement Scripture.

Scripture: Jude 1:3, Galatians 1:8-9, Revelation 22:18-19, 2 Timothy 3:16-17, Hebrews 1:1-2 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 1, Belgic Confession 7, all historic Protestant confessions

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Denied by Mormonism (Book of Mormon, D&C:, PGP), and by extension Community of Christ and FLDS. Also at issue with Branhamism and other 'new revelation' groups.

cult-mormon-jesus-satan-brothers

Cult Marker › Mormonism

ESSENTIAL

Jesus Christ is the eternal Son of God, of the same substance as the Father; Satan is a created fallen angel, not Christ's spirit-brother.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 10/10 · Consensus: orthodox · **Cult marker** · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. John 1:1-3 places Christ as the eternal Creator. Col 1:16 — all things including angels were created by him. Satan is a created being who fell; Christ is the uncreated Son. Equating them as 'spirit brothers' is blasphemy.

Scripture: John 1:1-3, Colossians 1:16-17, Hebrews 1:5-8, Isaiah 14:12-15, Ezekiel 28:14-17 | **Confessions:** Nicene Creed, Chalcedonian Definition, all historic creeds

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Taught by Mormonism (LDS): Jesus and Lucifer are spirit children of Heavenly Father. This denies Christ's eternal deity and is a cult-grade error.

cult-mormon-polytheism

Cult Marker › Mormonism

ESSENTIAL

There is one and only one true God, eternally and unchangeably; humans cannot become gods.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 10/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox · **Cult marker** · **Evangelism target if denied**

Rationale. Deut 6:4, Isa 43:10 ('before me no god was formed, nor shall there be any after me'), and 1 Tim 2:5 establish strict monotheism. Polytheism and the doctrine of human exaltation to godhood denies the Creator/creature distinction.

Scripture: Deuteronomy 6:4, Isaiah 43:10, Isaiah 44:6, 1 Timothy 2:5, Isaiah 45:5 | **Confessions:** Nicene Creed, Athanasian Creed, all historic creeds and confessions

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Denied by Mormonism (LDS): 'As man is, God once was; as God is, man may become' (Lorenzo Snow). LDS teaches a plurality of gods and human exaltation to godhood. This is polytheism and a definitive cult marker.

cult-oneness-modalism

Cult Marker › Oneness Pentecostalism

ESSENTIAL

The Father, Son, and Holy Spirit are three distinct Persons sharing one divine essence — not three modes or roles of one Person.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 10/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox · **Cult marker** · **Evangelism target if denied**

Rationale. At Christ's baptism the Father speaks from heaven, the Son is in the water, the Spirit descends (Matt 3:16-17) — three distinct Persons simultaneously. Christ prays to the Father (John 17), distinct from himself. Modalism (Sabellianism) was condemned in the early church.

Scripture: Matthew 3:16-17, John 17:1-5, John 14:16, Matthew 28:19, John 1:1-2 | **Confessions:** Nicene Creed, Athanasian Creed, condemnation of Sabellius (3rd century)

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Denied by Oneness Pentecostalism (United Pentecostal Church International, T.D. Jakes historically, Apostolic groups) — Jesus is the one God manifesting in three modes. This is ancient Sabellian heresy.

cult-sda-ellen-white-prophet

Cult Marker › Seventh-day Adventism

ESSENTIAL

Scripture is sufficient and the canon is closed; no modern individual (Ellen G. White) holds prophetic authority equal to or supplementing the apostles.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: orthodox · **Cult marker** · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. Heb 1:1-2 — God has spoken finally in his Son. Jude 3 — the faith once for all delivered. Granting Ellen White 'continuing authority' or 'lesser light' status compromises sola scriptura. Many SDAs are functional Christians, but the system has cult-grade markers.

Scripture: Hebrews 1:1-2, Jude 1:3, 2 Timothy 3:16-17, Galatians 1:8-9, Revelation 22:18-19 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 1, Belgic Confession 7

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Seventh-day Adventism elevates Ellen G. White as a 'lesser light' / 'spirit of prophecy.' Combined with investigative judgment, soul sleep, conditional immortality, and Sabbatarianism. Some classify SDA as cult, others as heterodox Christian; the Ellen White issue is the cult marker.

cult-the-way-international

Cult Marker › The Way International

ESSENTIAL

The historic doctrine of the Trinity is biblical and binding; movements denying it (e.g., The Way International) are heretical.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 10/10 · Consensus: orthodox · **Cult marker** · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. The Way International, founded by V.P. Wierwille, denies the Trinity, denies Christ's full deity, and teaches Jesus is not God. They also have authoritarian governance. Classic anti-Trinitarian cult.

Scripture: Matthew 28:19, John 1:1, John 20:28, 2 Corinthians 13:14 | **Confessions:** Nicene Creed, Athanasian Creed

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

The Way International (V.P. Wierwille, Power for Abundant Living) — denies Trinity, anti-Trinitarian, authoritarian. Cult.

cult-unification-church

Cult Marker › Unification Church

ESSENTIAL

Jesus Christ alone is the Messiah and Savior; no other person (Sun Myung Moon) is the 'second messiah' or true parent of mankind.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 10/10 · Consensus: orthodox · **Cult marker** · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. Acts 4:12 — there is no other name under heaven by which we must be saved. Sun Myung Moon claimed to be the 'Lord of the Second Advent' and Jesus' mission was incomplete. This is anti-Christ doctrine.

Scripture: Acts 4:12, 1 Timothy 2:5, John 14:6, Matthew 24:23-26, 1 John 2:22 | **Confessions:** all historic creeds

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Unification Church / Moonies (Sun Myung Moon) — Moon as second messiah, mass weddings, syncretism. Definitive cult.

cult-unitarian-trinity-denial

Cult Marker › Unitarianism

ESSENTIAL

There is one God eternally existing in three coequal, coeternal Persons — Father, Son, and Holy Spirit.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 10/10 · Consensus: orthodox · **Cult marker** · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. The Trinity is the fundamental Christian doctrine of God. Matt 28:19 (one name, three persons), 2 Cor 13:14, John 1:1, Acts 5:3-4 (Holy Spirit = God) establish it. Denial places one outside Christianity.

Scripture: Matthew 28:19, 2 Corinthians 13:14, John 1:1, Acts 5:3-4, John 14:16-17, Genesis 1:26 | **Confessions:** Nicene Creed (381), Athanasian Creed, Chalcedonian Definition, all historic creeds

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Denied by Unitarian Universalism, Iglesia ni Cristo, The Way International, Christadelphians, Jehovah's Witnesses, and Oneness Pentecostals (modalism).

het-british-israelism

Heterodoxy Marker › British Israelism

CONVICTIONAL

There is no biblical or genealogical basis for identifying modern Anglo-Saxons or Europeans as the lost tribes of Israel; Christian Identity racialism is heretical.

Position: DENY · Martyrdom: 6/10 · Consensus: heterodox

Rationale. Gal 3:28 — neither Jew nor Greek, all one in Christ. The 'lost tribes' returned in part and were absorbed; modern Israel is a mixed people. Christian Identity weaponizes this into white supremacy and antisemitism — both heretical and morally evil.

Scripture: Galatians 3:28, Acts 17:26, Romans 11:25-29, Colossians 3:11 | **Confessions:** all historic creeds and confessions

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

British Israelism / Christian Identity / Worldwide Church of God (Herbert W. Armstrong, in original form). When combined with white supremacy (Christian Identity movement) it crosses into cult-grade. Armstrongism in original form was anti-Trinitarian and cult-classified.

het-hyper-grace-antinomianism

Heterodoxy Marker › Antinomianism

CONVICTIONAL

Grace empowers believers to walk in holiness; the moral law remains binding as the rule of life for the believer, though not as the means of justification.

Position: DENY · Martyrdom: 5/10 · Consensus: heterodox

Rationale. Rom 6:1-2 — shall we sin that grace may abound? By no means. The Sermon on the Mount intensifies, not abolishes, moral demand. Hyper-grace teachers (e.g., Joseph Prince in popular form) sometimes deny the need for confession of sin or repentance, which is antinomianism.

Scripture: Romans 6:1-14, Titus 2:11-12, 1 John 1:9, 1 John 3:4-10, Matthew 5:17-20 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 19, Heidelberg Catechism (third use of the law)

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	-

Hyper-grace / antinomianism — historically condemned (Marrow Controversy). Modern popular teachers vary in degree. Distinguish genuine free-grace teaching from antinomian distortion.

het-icon-veneration

Heterodoxy Marker › Eastern Orthodoxy

CONVICTIONAL

Veneration of icons (proskynesis) and prayers to saints are rejected as violating the second commandment and Christ's unique mediation.

Position: DENY · Martyrdom: 5/10 · Consensus: divided

Rationale. Ex 20:4-5 forbids making and bowing before images. While Eastern Orthodoxy distinguishes veneration (dulia) from worship (latria), in practice the second commandment is violated. 1 Tim 2:5 — one mediator. The Brethren and Reformed traditions have always rejected icon veneration.

Scripture: Exodus 20:4-5, Deuteronomy 5:8-9, 1 Timothy 2:5, Acts 10:25-26, Revelation 22:8-9 | **Confessions:** Heidelberg Catechism 96-98, Westminster Larger Catechism 109, Reformation consensus

Visit	Y	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	-

Eastern Orthodoxy and Roman Catholicism. EO is heterodox (not cult) — preserves Trinity, deity of Christ, bodily resurrection. Iconoclast controversy (8th-9th c.) settled in EO favor at Nicaea II; Reformers rejected this.

CONVICTIONAL

New Apostolic Reformation (NAR) — C. Peter Wagner, Bill Hamon, Mike Bickle (IHOPKC), Bethel/Bill Johnson, Che Ahn, Lou Engle. Often combined with prosperity, dominionism (Seven Mountain Mandate), and false prophecy. Highly relevant in London charismatic scene.

CONVICTIONAL

Open theism (Clark Pinnock, Greg Boyd, John Sanders) — denies exhaustive foreknowledge. Considered heterodox by virtually all confessional traditions; some (e.g., Bruce Ware) call it heretical.

het-papal-infallibility

Heterodoxy Marker › Roman Catholicism

CONVICTIONAL

No human bishop or council possesses infallibility ex cathedra; Scripture alone is the infallible rule of faith and life.

Position: DENY · **Martyrdom:** 6/10 · **Consensus:** divided

Rationale. Sola scriptura. The papacy itself is a post-apostolic development; even Peter was rebuked by Paul (Gal 2:11). Vatican I (1870) defined papal infallibility on faith and morals — a novel claim with no apostolic warrant.

Scripture: 2 Timothy 3:16-17, Galatians 2:11-14, Acts 17:11, Mark 7:8-9 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 1, Belgic Confession 7, Thirty-Nine Articles 21, Reformation consensus

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	-

Roman Catholicism. The split with Eastern Orthodoxy (1054) was partly over papal claims; Reformation reaffirmed Scripture's supremacy.

het-prosperity-gospel

Heterodoxy Marker › Word-Faith

CONVICTIONAL

The gospel is the good news of forgiveness of sins through Christ; God does not guarantee health and material wealth in this life to believers.

Position: DENY · **Martyrdom:** 7/10 · **Consensus:** heterodox

Rationale. Christ promised tribulation in this world (John 16:33). Paul lists his sufferings (2 Cor 11) — the prosperity gospel would call him a man of small faith. The 'little gods' doctrine borders on cult-grade. Paul-Bunyan-style faith preachers (Hagin, Copeland, Hinn, etc.) distort the gospel into a transactional health-and-wealth scheme.

Scripture: John 16:33, 2 Corinthians 11:23-29, Philippians 4:11-13, 1 Timothy 6:5-10, James 4:3 | **Confessions:** historic Reformed and Brethren tradition

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Prosperity gospel / Word-Faith (Kenneth Hagin, Kenneth Copeland, Benny Hinn, Joel Osteen, Creflo Dollar, T.D. Jakes). Some forms (e.g., 'little gods' doctrine) approach cult-grade. Pervasive in NAR and global Pentecostalism. Highly relevant for evaluating London charismatic churches.

het-rc-marian-dogmas

Heterodoxy Marker › Roman Catholicism

CONVICTIONAL

Mary was a sinner saved by grace like every other believer; she was not immaculately conceived, was not bodily assumed, and is not co-redemptrix.

Position: DENY · Martyrdom: 5/10 · Consensus: divided

Rationale. Rom 3:23 — all have sinned. Christ is the one mediator (1 Tim 2:5). The Marian dogmas (Immaculate Conception 1854, Assumption 1950, Co-redemptrix proposed) lack scriptural basis and obscure Christ's unique mediation.

Scripture: Romans 3:23, 1 Timothy 2:5, Luke 1:47, Hebrews 7:25 | Confessions: Thirty-Nine Articles 22, Westminster Confession, Heidelberg Catechism, Reformation consensus

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	-

Roman Catholicism — heterodox not cult, because RC retains Trinity, deity of Christ, bodily resurrection, and (in principle) salvation by grace through Christ. But Marian dogmas, papal infallibility, and treasury of merit are serious errors. Many genuine Christians are in the RC church despite the system.

Spiritual Gifts

prc-healing-in-atonement-guaranteed

Spiritual Gifts › Healing

CONVICTIONAL

Physical healing is guaranteed in the atonement for every believer in this life (such that lack of healing implies lack of faith).

Position: DENY · Martyrdom: 6/10 · Consensus: heterodox

Rationale. Isaiah 53 / Matthew 8 cite atonement healing eschatologically and not as a present-life guarantee; saints in Scripture suffered ongoing illness.

Scripture: Isaiah 53:4-5, Matthew 8:16-17, Romans 8:18-23, 2 Corinthians 4:16-17

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Dangerous pastorally — wounds the sick by blaming their faith.

prc-hyper-charismatic-excess

Spiritual Gifts › Charismatic Excess

CONVICTIONAL

Hyper-charismatic excess — slain in the Spirit as normative, holy laughter, Toronto Blessing phenomena, Bethel/NAR-style signs, fire tunnels, prophetic decrees binding consciences — is to be rejected as disorderly and unscriptural.

Position: DENY · **Martyrdom:** 6/10 · **Consensus:** heterodox

Rationale. 1 Cor 14 demands order; the fruit of these movements is frequently false prophecy, manipulation, and undermining of Scripture's sufficiency.

Scripture: 1 Corinthians 14:33, 1 Corinthians 14:40, Deuteronomy 18:20-22, 1 John 4:1

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Visit only with sharp discernment, e.g., for evaluation. Member=false. Distinguish from moderate continuationism above.

prc-modern-apostles

Spiritual Gifts › Offices

CONVICTIONAL

The office of Apostle (in the foundational sense — eyewitness of the risen Christ, sent with Christ's authority to lay the church's foundation) ceased with the apostolic generation.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 6/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox

Rationale. Apostleship requires direct commissioning by the risen Christ and eyewitness status (Acts 1:21-22, 1 Cor 9:1). The church is built on the foundation of the apostles, not continually re-founded. NAR claims of restored apostles are heterodox.

Scripture: Ephesians 2:20, Acts 1:21-22, 1 Corinthians 9:1, Revelation 21:14

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Functional 'apostolic' missionary work (church-planting) is fine; claims to apostolic office and authority are not.

prc-prophecy-fallible-vs-binding

Spiritual Gifts › Prophecy

CONVICTIONAL

Any modern claim to prophecy must be tested by Scripture and is never binding on conscience the way Scripture is. New revelation that adds to or contradicts Scripture is rejected.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 6/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox

Rationale. Sufficiency of Scripture and the closed canon. 1 Thess 5:20-21 commands testing. Deut 18 standard for prophets is high — false prophecy is judged.

Scripture: 1 Thessalonians 5:20-21, Deuteronomy 18:20-22, Revelation 22:18-19, 2 Timothy 3:16-17 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 1.6

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Cult-marker if a 'prophet' demands Scripture-equal obedience.

prc-tongues-as-evidence-of-salvation

Spiritual Gifts › Tongues

CONVICTIONAL

Speaking in tongues is the necessary evidence of Spirit baptism and/or genuine salvation (classical Pentecostal initial-evidence doctrine).

Position: DENY · Martyrdom: 6/10 · Consensus: minority

Rationale. Scripture distributes gifts as the Spirit wills (1 Cor 12:11, 30); tongues are not universal. Conditioning assurance on tongues introduces a works-tongue test alien to the gospel.

Scripture: 1 Corinthians 12:11, 1 Corinthians 12:30, Romans 8:16, Galatians 3:2

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Adds a condition to salvation/assurance beyond faith in Christ. This is the classical Pentecostal extreme; many modern Pentecostals have softened it.

prc-word-of-faith

Spiritual Gifts › Word of Faith

CONVICTIONAL

Word of Faith / 'name it and claim it' / decreeing and declaring as a creative force of human speech is a false gospel that confuses the creature with the Creator.

Position: DENY · Martyrdom: 7/10 · Consensus: heterodox · Cult marker · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. Treats human speech as having God-like creative authority; shifts faith from God to the believer's own words; distorts the atonement and sovereignty of God.

Scripture: Isaiah 55:8-11, Psalm 115:3, James 4:13-15, 1 Timothy 6:5

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

In its most aggressive form (humans as 'little gods' speaking realities into existence), this edges into cult-grade theology — cult_marker=true. evangelism_target=true because consistent WoF teaching presents a different gospel.

Christian Ethics

prc-pro-choice-position

Christian Ethics › Sanctity of Life

ESSENTIAL

Pro-choice ethics — that elective abortion is morally neutral or a Christian-liberty matter — is incompatible with biblical anthropology and the sixth commandment.

Position: DENY · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: heterodox

Rationale. Denies Imago Dei in the unborn.

Scripture: Exodus 20:13, Psalm 139:13-16, Proverbs 6:16-17

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Pastoral care for women who have had abortions is essential; the doctrinal stance is not negotiable.

prc-sanctity-of-life

Christian Ethics › Sanctity of Life

ESSENTIAL

Human life bears the image of God from conception to natural death and is to be protected; intentional taking of innocent unborn human life (abortion) is sin.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Imago Dei from conception (Ps 139); the sixth commandment; consistent witness of historic Christianity from the Didache onward.

Scripture: Psalm 139:13-16, Exodus 20:13, Jeremiah 1:5, Luke 1:41-44, Genesis 1:27 | Confessions: Didache 2.2

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Compassion for women in crisis; refusal to call evil good. A church teaching pro-choice as Christian ethic disqualifies for membership.

prc-civil-disobedience

Christian Ethics › Civil Authority

CONVICTIONAL

Christians submit to civil authority as God's servant, but must obey God rather than man when laws command sin or forbid commanded obedience.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 7/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Romans 13 and Acts 5:29 in tension and harmony.

Scripture: Romans 13:1-7, Acts 5:29, Daniel 3, Daniel 6

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	Y	Member	Y
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	-	Break fellow.	-

Pertinent in UK speech-law and ethics climate.

prc-euthanasia

Christian Ethics › End of Life

CONVICTIONAL

Active euthanasia and assisted suicide are wrong; allowing natural death and refusing futile treatment is permitted.

Position: DENY · Martyrdom: 7/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Sixth commandment; God's sovereignty over life and death; distinct from refusing burdensome treatment.

Scripture: Exodus 20:13, Job 1:21, Deuteronomy 32:39

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Increasing UK pressure on this; baseline is firm.

prc-honesty-and-restitution

Christian Ethics › Integrity

CONVICTIONAL

Truth-telling, integrity in word, and restitution where wrong has been done are required Christian practice.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 6/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Ninth commandment; Zacchaeus pattern of restitution; abundant NT teaching on honest speech.

Scripture: Exodus 20:16, Ephesians 4:25, Luke 19:8, Colossians 3:9-10

Visit	-	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Refers to teaching, not personal failure.

Marriage & Sexuality

prc-gender-binary

Marriage & Sexuality › Gender

ESSENTIAL

God created humanity male and female; biological sex is binary, given by God, and immutable. Transgender ideology — that gender identity supersedes biological sex — is to be rejected.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 9/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. Genesis 1:27 'male and female he created them'; affirmed by Christ (Matt 19:4); the body is the person's covenanted self.

Scripture: Genesis 1:27, Matthew 19:4, Deuteronomy 22:5, Psalm 139:13-16

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Pastoral compassion for those experiencing dysphoria; doctrinal stance not negotiable. Pronoun policy is a separate prudential matter.

prc-marriage-one-man-one-woman

Marriage & Sexuality › Definition of Marriage

ESSENTIAL

Marriage is a covenant union of one man and one woman, instituted by God at creation, intended for life, picturing Christ and the church.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 9/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox

Rationale. Genesis 2:24 — affirmed by Christ in Matt 19; Eph 5 anchors marriage in the gospel mystery.

Scripture: Genesis 2:24, Matthew 19:4-6, Ephesians 5:31-32, Mark 10:6-9 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 24

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Essential. Church redefining marriage cannot be a member-church.

prc-same-sex-sexual-activity

Marriage & Sexuality › Sexual Ethics

ESSENTIAL

Same-sex sexual activity is sin, contrary to creation design and the consistent witness of Scripture; same-sex marriage is illegitimate.

Position: DENY · **Martyrdom:** 9/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox

Rationale. Romans 1, 1 Corinthians 6, Leviticus 18, Genesis 1-2 — affirmed across the historic church.

Scripture: Romans 1:26-27, 1 Corinthians 6:9-10, Leviticus 18:22, 1 Timothy 1:9-10, Genesis 19

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Affirming churches cannot be member-churches. Same-sex-attracted Christians pursuing chastity are honored siblings.

prc-divorce-and-remarriage

Marriage & Sexuality › Divorce

CONVICTIONAL

Marriage is intended for life; divorce is permitted only in cases of sexual immorality (Matt 19) and abandonment by an unbelieving spouse (1 Cor 7); remarriage after such biblically permitted divorce is permissible.

Position: AFFIRM · **Martyrdom:** 6/10 · **Consensus:** divided

Rationale. Christ's exception clause; Pauline privilege; Brethren reading.

Scripture: Matthew 19:9, 1 Corinthians 7:15, Malachi 2:16, Mark 10:11-12 | **Confessions:** Westminster Confession 24.5-6

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	Y	Member	Y
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	-	Break fellow.	-

Pastoral nuance; abuse cases handled with care under abandonment principle.

prc-pornography

Marriage & Sexuality › Sexual Ethics

CONVICTIONAL

Pornography use is sin — adultery of the heart, exploitation of those in the industry, and corrosive of the marriage bed.

Position: DENY · **Martyrdom:** 6/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox

Rationale. Matthew 5:28; the consistent witness of NT sexual purity teaching.

Scripture: Matthew 5:27-28, 1 Thessalonians 4:3-5, Job 31:1, Psalm 101:3

Visit	-	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

About teaching, not personal struggle. Strugglers receive grace and accountability.

prc-pre-marital-sex-and-cohabitation

Marriage & Sexuality › Sexual Ethics

CONVICTIONAL

Sexual intimacy is reserved for marriage between one man and one woman; pre-marital sex (fornication) and unmarried cohabitation that includes sexual relations are sin.

Position: DENY · **Martyrdom:** 7/10 · **Consensus:** orthodox

Rationale. Hebrews 13:4; 1 Cor 6:18; 1 Thess 4:3-5.

Scripture: Hebrews 13:4, 1 Corinthians 6:18-20, 1 Thessalonians 4:3-5, Ephesians 5:3

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Cohabiting believers should be counseled toward marriage or separation; teaching otherwise is the disqualifier.

Family & Discipleship

CONVICTIONAL

CONVICTIONAL

prc-financial-transparency

Money & Stewardship › Church Finances

CONVICTIONAL

Church finances should be handled with integrity, transparency, plural oversight, and openness to the congregation.

Position: AFFIRM · Martyrdom: 6/10 · Consensus: orthodox

Rationale. 2 Cor 8:18-21 — Paul's careful handling 'in the sight of the Lord but also in the sight of man.'

Scripture: 2 Corinthians 8:18-21, Acts 6:1-6

Visit	Y	Participate	Y	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	-

Opaque finances are a serious red flag and a frequent vector of cultic abuse.

prc-prosperity-gospel

Money & Stewardship › Prosperity

CONVICTIONAL

The prosperity gospel — the teaching that financial wealth and physical health are guaranteed for the faithful, often unlocked by giving (seed-faith) — is a false gospel.

Position: DENY · Martyrdom: 7/10 · Consensus: heterodox · Evangelism target if denied

Rationale. Contradicts the cross, the example of Christ and the apostles, and the New Testament teaching on suffering, contentment, and the eschatological hope. Exploits the poor.

Scripture: 1 Timothy 6:5-10, 2 Corinthians 8:9, Philippians 4:11-13, James 5:1-6, Matthew 6:19-21

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	-	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Consistent prosperity preaching is a different gospel — evangelism_target=true. Heterodox rather than cultic per se, but functionally devastating.

Engagement with World

prc-social-justice-as-gospel

Engagement with World › Social Concern

CONVICTIONAL

Biblical justice — care for the poor, the orphan, the widow, the oppressed — is a Christian duty; but ideological 'social justice' that supplants the gospel of forgiveness in Christ with group-based justice is a different gospel.

Position: DENY · **Martyrdom:** 6/10 · **Consensus:** divided

Rationale. Brethren affirm justice as biblical (Mic 6:8) but deny social-justice-as-gospel substitution. Galatians anathema applies to any other gospel.

Scripture: Micah 6:8, James 1:27, Galatians 1:6-9, Isaiah 1:17

Visit	-	Participate	-	Serve in min.	-	Member	-
Marry across	Y	Teach to kids	Y	Correct	Y	Break fellow.	Y

Distinguish: justice ministry = good; gospel-as-justice = false gospel.